

DELORES SWALLOWS

Indigame
OPEN AND
CLOSED

Endgame: Open and Closed

A Very Open Arrangement (Book 4)

by Delores Swallows

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ENDGAME: OPEN AND CLOSED

After the trials and tribulations of our couples' holiday in Mexico, things between Suzy and I became so strained we were barely talking to one another. What was worse, even the idea of her sneaking off to see another man didn't give the thrill that it used to.

The hardest part about coming back from Mexico was that the woman I really wanted to be with was still on the other side of the Atlantic. This was made even clearer when Cyndi and I shared a few intimate videocalls. I knew I had a big decision to make.

As it turned out, Suzy's egocentric desire for satisfying her own needs helped me make the decision. We may have had a very open arrangement, but that didn't mean that I couldn't close my account and go elsewhere...

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

ALSO BY DELORES SWALLOWS

Ψ



CHAPTER 1

On my first day back at work after our holiday, my colleagues all commented on how tanned I was. They also pointed out that I didn't seem particularly happy to be back. Some thought I was suffering from post-holiday blues, others suggested jet lag. I explained that thirty-six hours earlier, I'd been drinking mojitos on a beach, surrounded by beautiful women in bikinis, and looking out at the turquoise waters of the Gulf of Mexico. It was hardly surprising, I reasoned, that being stuck in a small office with four ugly men on a cold grey day in England was going to be depressing.

None of the men I worked with were what I'd call close friends, so I wasn't going to tell them that I was going through something a lot more serious than post-holiday blues. They didn't know we'd been to a 'couples who play' resort. Nor did they know anything about how our private lives had changed over the past few months.

By late afternoon I couldn't stop yawning, so I headed out and got into my car. Traffic was as bad as ever around Cambridge, but I didn't mind it this time. Truth be told, I was dreading going home. Things had been pretty frosty between me and Suzy since early in our holiday, and they'd gotten steadily worse as the week progressed. We hardly spoke to each other through the entire ten-hour flight back to England.

Suzy had taken an extra day's leave, so she'd been sleeping when I left for work that morning. When I arrived at our house, her car wasn't on the drive. At first I was relieved that there'd be no confrontation, but then I wondered if she'd actually moved out. The fact I wasn't sure how I felt about the possibility should have upset me, but it didn't.

I locked the car and headed for the house but before I'd reached the door, my mobile started ringing. I took it from my pocket, half-expecting it to be my wife, then saw it was a call from Stig, an old friend from my army days.

"Hi Stig," I said, using my key to open the front door.

"Hey Rob, how's it going?"

"Okay, thanks." It was a lie. "How're you?"

"Yeah, all good here. Listen, I was just phoning to ask if you guys are going to the squad reunion in a couple of weeks."

I frowned, closing the door behind me and glancing around the hall. Several of Suzy's coats were on the rack, which made me think maybe she hadn't moved out. "What squad reunion?"

"Apparently it's ten years since we built that drinking station in Somalia, and they've decided to celebrate it with an informal get-together in—"

"I wasn't involved with that."

Stig paused. "What?"

"The drinking station thing. I never worked on it. While you guys were doing that, I was serving as security detail for the visit of some of our government ministers to Mogadishu."

"Oh yeah, I remember that now."

I saw a note on the coffee table and made my way towards it.

"Well," Stig said, letting out a long breath. "I don't suppose you'll be going then."

I was barely listening as I picked up Suzy's note. It was short but non-toxic:

Gone to a cycle-meet. I'll be back about 9. I've already eaten. Sx

That explained her absence, and at least she'd put a kiss on her note. I realised Stig was still talking and I hadn't been listening. "Sorry mate, I didn't catch that."

"I asked when you guys are going to Mexico."

"We've been. Got back in the early hours of yesterday."

"Cool. So, how was it?"

My mind raced as I tried to remember how much we'd told him. Although Stig was aware of our open relationship – he'd taken full advantage of it during a weekend in Yorkshire when he'd fucked every hole in Suzy's body – I don't think he knew the type of resort we'd visited. "It was hot."

"You're aware that Mexico is in the tropics, right?"

I laughed, then dropped into an armchair. "What I mean is, the holiday itself was hot. We went to a resort for swingers."

"Really? Oh, you dirty buggers."

I laughed, then let out a long sigh. "I think it may have been a mistake."

"Couldn't you keep up with all the dirty women?"

"That wasn't the problem."

Stig was silent for a moment, and I guessed he'd picked up on my tone. "So did something go wrong?"

“You could say that. I think...” I closed my eyes and shook my head, half-regretting saying anything. But Stig was one of my closest friends and one of the few people I could actually talk to about our swinging issues. “We went with big plans. Lots of kinky fun, but with the understanding that we’d play safe and only do what we both wanted to.”

“But?”

“But Suzy ran wild and fucked anything with a pulse. And the part about the playing safe went straight out of her head.”

“Oh.”

I contemplated telling him about her night out with Daisy but decided against it.

“So, how are the pair of you now?” Stig asked. “I mean, apart from sore from all the shagging.”

I laughed. “Things are a bit icy, to say the least. Before we went, we were as close as we’ve ever been. Now...” I glanced around the living room. “When I got home from work and she wasn’t here, I wondered if she’d left.”

“Jeez, Rob. I didn’t realise things were that bad.”

“I’m probably overreacting. We’ve never really argued before, so maybe that’s why these last few days are so hard to take.” I let out another sigh. “I’m sure it’ll all be fine.”

“No more kinky fun for a while?” he asked.

“Suzy once said if either of us wanted to stop, we’d stop.”

There was a brief silence. “And?”

“She seems to have forgotten that deal and says if I want to stop, she’s happy to go out on the pull on her own.”

“So she doesn’t want to stop?”

“No.”

“How about you?”

In my mind, I saw Cyndi’s beautiful face. But Cyndi lived in America, and I was in England. “I don’t know.”

“I’m sorry, mate. I don’t know what to say.”

“There’s nothing to say. I knew we were playing with fire, so I have to accept the consequences when I get burned.” I tried to be philosophical but didn’t sound very convincing. “I’m sure things will get sorted one way or the other.” I then remembered he and his wife had a holiday booked. “When are you and Mandy going to Italy?”

“September.”

“Cool. Well, have a great time.”

“Yeah. Right, as I said, I just called to see if you were going to the reunion. I’d forgotten you weren’t part of it.”

“No, but I can’t believe it was ten years ago. Makes me feel old.”

Stig laughed. “No, you’re feeling old because you’re just back from a shag-fest and your body’s reminding you you’re no longer in your twenties.”

After we’d hung up I wandered into the kitchen. The fridge was pretty bare on account of us being away for a week. I could either buy something

to cook, or I could get a pizza delivered. The decision took seconds, and after phoning in my order I went to change into a t-shirt and joggers.

The pizza arrived. It smelled better than it tasted, so I ended up leaving a couple of slices in the box. I made myself a coffee, determined to stay awake as long as I could to try and get my body clock back on UK time. There was still over two hours before Suzy would return, and I wasn't sure what to do until then. I took out my phone, skimmed through the news and sports, then opened my email app. My heart skipped a beat when I saw there was a message from Cyndi.

Cyndi and her partner Dean had been the first couple we'd swapped with on our Mexican holiday. Even though it'd been Suzy and Dean who'd made the initial contact, Cyndi and I had clicked. My wife had chosen to blame Cyndi for whatever problem she and I were now having in our marriage. I opened the email and was a little disappointed that it was only a couple of lines.

Hey Stranger – Hope you enjoyed the rest of your holiday and got back home okay. I wish we could do it all over again. Cyndi.

As I read her words, a strange mix of emotions engulfed me. I felt a warm contentment remembering our two dates, but I also experienced a cold sense of loss. It was weird, and I kept reminding myself that Cyndi and I had been simply ships passing in the night. We'd met on a swinging holiday, enjoyed a couple of trysts, then gone back to our own lives. Or had we? My life certainly wasn't the same, that was certain.

I knew I was acting like a love-sick teenager. Maybe Cyndi was just another slut. She'd admitted that she'd fucked sixteen men during her week at the resort. Suzy's rant echoed in my mind. *What makes you think you're*

so special? But I still felt that what had happened between Cyndi and me was more than a brief partner exchange. I clung to the feeling that there'd been a closer connection.

I decided to reply to Cyndi's email using my laptop. Fat thumbs and auto-correct often rendered things I wrote on my phone as gobbledygook. I fired up my laptop and logged onto the email account. Before opening Cyndi's latest message, I clicked on the first one she'd sent, which was just the selfie she'd taken in Mexico. As I stared at the image, an ironic smile on her beautiful face as she sat in the chair by the path to the beach, longing spread through me. It wasn't just lust. I'd have given anything to just wrap her in my arms and hold her close.

I clicked on her latest email and hit the 'reply' arrow. Then I started typing.

Hey yourself

I won't bore you with the details of the rest of my holiday, nor with what it's like being back home – but it's cold weather inside and outside of our house.

I wish more than anything that we could do it all over again.

How's life back in Alabama?

I started back at work today but I'm still jet-lagged. What I wouldn't give for another evening sitting in that garden under the tree with fairy lights.

xxxx

There was a lot more I wanted to write, but something stopped me. Maybe what Suzy had said about me having no idea how Cyndi had acted

with every other man she'd sucked and fucked on holiday was finally getting through to me. Maybe I'd been looking through rose-tinted glasses.

My chest tightened when I saw Cyndi had replied already. I clicked on that email.

Where are you now? Who are you with?

The fact I knew she was on the other end of the line – or ether – gave me a thrill. I smiled as I typed.

I'm like Macauley Culkin. Home alone.

Her response was immediate, and it made my heart race.

Can we do a videocall?

I looked at the options on the email page but couldn't see a way to make a videocall. None of the little icons had a camera on them.

Yeah, but I don't know how.

Another message arrived.

I do. xxx

I stared at my laptop screen for a few moments, and then another email arrived. When I clicked on it, I got a message saying Cyndi's email address was inviting me to join a video call happening now. I clicked on a blue square marked 'Join Call'. I then clicked through another couple of screens asking my permission to allow it to use the camera and microphone, then suddenly Cyndi's gorgeous face filled my laptop screen. A small screen in the lower right corner showed my own image.

She smiled, her perfect white teeth bright against the flawless dark skin of her face. I was taken aback by the swell of need I felt inside.

“Hey Rob,” she said, tipping her head slightly to the side. “Long time, no see.” Her American accent sounded stronger than I remembered.

“Too long,” I said, nodding and grinning like an idiot.

We gawped at each other for a few moments, then I said I liked her high-necked cream blouse. Laughing, she explained she was wearing her work clothes. She then stood up and did a twirl, showing off a pair of dark blue trousers and explained that third grade teachers had to dress a certain way for school. I loved how the trousers hugged her peach-shaped bum, though I didn’t tell her that.

“So, how’ve you been?” She leaned forward and studied her screen. “Your tan is definitely darker than I remember it.”

“Yeah. I spent my last few days lying by the pool, soaking up the sun.”

“What about Suzy?”

“She was lying somewhere else, and probably soaking up something else, too.”

“For real?”

I nodded. “Things went kind of downhill pretty quickly after you left.”

“How so?”

I told her about the state Suzy had been in when she got home after her night out with Daisy, when I’d been with Cyndi in the garden. My wife had been too drunk to talk, and when she’d managed to remove her cum-stained dress, I’d been rewarded with the sight of dried-on semen all over her body. Cyndi’s big brown eyes got wider with each revelation.

“Do you know where she’d been?” she asked.

“Not at first. She passed out, so the next morning I left her sleeping and walked into town. I came back in the afternoon to find she’d vomited most of the booze from her system. That’s when she told me she’d been the floor show in an upstairs room.”

“Oh God. I heard about that place.”

“And when she’d taken on all-comers on the stage, she went out to the terrace and took on all the wait-staff on a table.”

Cyndi gasped and shook her head. “What did you say?”

“What could I say? I let her sleep it off. She spent over 36 hours in bed. That’s when I got your emails from the airport.”

She gave an embarrassed smile. “Sorry.”

“I’m not. They were the only reason I smiled that day.” I flashed her a smile, then took a breath. “When I told Suzy about my walk into town, she said she’d like to see it as well. So the next morning we walked in and found an outside café. There was an older couple at the next table, a big black guy whose wife was almost as big. They were regulars at the resort who liked the town enough to buy themselves a winter home there. The guy, Ed, couldn’t keep his eyes off Suzy, and she was straight back into slut mode. Big eyes, pouty lips, a flash of leg.” I sighed. “In the cabin the night before, she’d been all apologetic and ashamed of herself. But as soon as another guy leered at her, she was all hot and frisky.”

Cyndi looked horrified. “You said his wife was as big as he was.”

I nodded. “They offered to show us around town and, unsurprisingly, Suzy and Ed rushed off ahead. His wife looked embarrassed. She knew Suzy and Ed were up for it, and...”

“She knew you weren’t.”

“She was a nice woman.” I smiled and shook my head. “Big brown eyes that reminded me of yours. Big brown tits that didn’t remind me of yours.”

Cyndi’s mouth dropped open. “You didn’t.”

I laughed and felt no guilt. “I fucking did.”

“Good for you. How was it?”

“She picked me up, threw me onto the couch and abused my body.” I grinned. “I loved every minute of it.”

Cyndi laughed and leaned back in her chair. “And I assume Suzy got what she wanted?”

“Oh yeah.” I turned serious. “She actually said she didn’t think I’d be able to get it up.”

“Really?” Cyndi frowned. “And yet she still went for the husband.”

“Exactly.” I let out a long breath. “After that, we walked back to the resort and went our separate ways. I spent my days by the pool and my evenings reading in the cabin. I don’t know where Suzy spent her days, but she only came home on one of the remaining nights.”

“She kept swinging?”

“Oh yeah.”

“And you didn’t?” She looked kind of sad for me.

“No, I...” I shrugged. “It lost its appeal after you left.”

Cyndi’s angelic face stared out at me from the screen for a long moment, then she frowned. “I broke up with Dean when we got home.”

“Oh?” I wanted to smile. Childish, I know, but he didn’t deserve her.

She shrugged. "I mean, we weren't like a regular couple, anyways."

"Just fuck buddies," I said, remembering her telling me exactly that.

She laughed and shrugged. "Yeah. I think we mainly used each other to get into swinger parties."

My chest tightened. "So, who are you going to use to get into swinger parties from now on?"

She smiled, then looked a little sad. "I think I'll give them a miss for a while. Maybe they've lost their appeal for me, too. I can just, you know..." She scrunched up her nose then smiled. "Stay home and tug my nipples."

I burst out laughing. Cyndi had admitted that even though her boobs were very small, her nipples were so sensitive she could make herself come just by playing with them. I'd put it to the test and made her come that way on the last night we'd seen each other.

"I miss your laugh," she said, looking incredibly vulnerable.

Her words took my breath away, and I sighed. "I miss everything about you."

We stared at each other in silence for a while, then she shook her head. "So, your email said it was cold inside and outside the house."

I nodded. "We've hardly spoken."

"Where's Suzy now?"

"Cycling. At least that's what her note said."

Cyndi's eyebrows dipped. "You think she's out riding something other than her bike?"

I shrugged. "I hadn't considered that possibility."

“Would you care?”

I thought about it, then shook my head. “Not really.”

A loud knock came through the speaker, making me jump. Cyndi looked over her shoulder then back at the laptop. “Sorry, that’s my pupil for his lesson.”

“Do you do individual tutoring?”

She nodded. “Just a few kids who are struggling in class.”

“Gotta earn some extra cash to get back to Mexico next year, I guess.”

She scoffed. “I don’t charge. Their parents can’t afford to pay, so I do it for nothing.”

I was speechless.

Cyndi stood up and then had to bend over to look into the camera. She flashed me a smile. “Can we do this again?”

“Will you play with your nipples next time?”

She laughed and shook her head. “You want to see me play with my nipples, get a plane over to Alabama.”

We both held eye contact, then she frowned and reached for her keyboard. The screen went black.

I closed the lid of my laptop, sat back in the chair and closed my eyes. Suzy would be home later, and I wasn’t in the mood to see her. I decided to have a shower and read in bed until my fatigue caught up with me.



Ψ



CHAPTER 2

I woke before six and found Suzy sleeping next to me. She hadn't woken me when she came to bed, so I didn't know when that had been. I slipped out and headed downstairs. Her cycling shoes were in the hall, and I found the empty pizza box on the coffee table. I'd left it with two slices in the kitchen. Whatever Suzy had been doing the night before, she'd worked up an appetite and worn her cycling shoes. I remember when the idea of that would have turned me on.

"Morning."

I turned as Suzy walked into the kitchen wearing her robe. "Hi. How was cycling?"

"Hard but good. I ate your leftover pizza. I hope you weren't saving it for your breakfast."

I laughed and shook my head. "No, it's fine." There was still a weird distance between us, and I wasn't sure how to fix it. "Are you back to work today?"

"Yeah. I can't say I'm looking forward to it, but..." She shrugged. "How was your first day back yesterday?"

"I couldn't stop yawning."

"You were dead to the world when I got home last night. I caught up on my sleep yesterday, so..." She opened the fridge door and frowned. "Maybe I should have gone shopping instead of sleeping." She closed it and sighed. "I'll call for a pastry on the way to work." With that, she headed upstairs and a minute later, I heard the shower running.

When she'd finished in the bathroom, I shaved and brushed my teeth. Back in the bedroom, Suzy had dried her hair and was applying makeup.

"Will you be in or out tonight?" I asked as I got dressed.

She looked at me for a second, then frowned. "I'm not sure. Do you need an answer now?"

"Not really." I couldn't help wondering if she was hoping to arrange something. "Right, I'm off."

"Okay." She turned her back and dropped onto the bed to put on her shoes. The coldness between us wasn't showing any signs of thawing. I walked downstairs, picked up my keys and left.

The traffic was even worse than usual, and halfway along the A14 I saw two cars that had been in a collision being winched up onto the back of a tow-truck. By the time I got to work, everyone else was in the office.

Pete, whose desk was next to mine, pointed to a Post-it note stuck to my computer screen. "You had a call earlier. Maybe it's one of your Mexican women."

I blinked, immediately thinking of Cyndi. "A woman phoned me *here*?"

He nodded. "It came through from the switchboard."

I picked up the note. It had Pete's untidy scrawl of a name and a number. Apart from the capital A at the start, I couldn't read the rest of the name. "Is this written in code?"

"Cheeky twat. It says Alannah."

I checked the digits and pointed to one of them. "Is that a seven or a two?"

“Fuck off, it’s obviously a seven.”

Still a little confused, I dropped into my chair and called the number. It was picked up on the second ring. “Hello?”

“Hi, I’m returning your call from earlier this—”

“Rob?”

I frowned. The voice was familiar. “Yes.”

“Hi, thanks for calling me back. It’s Elena. We met in our chalet in Cornwall a couple of weeks back.”

“*Elena.*” I emphasised the ‘lay’ sound of the middle syllable and frowned at Pete. The name sounded nothing like Alannah. “How are you?” What I really wanted to know was, how did a woman we’d met through the swinging website know where I worked.

“I’m fine, thanks. Listen, I’m working in Bedford for a couple of days and remembered you lived in Cambridge, so I wondered if you fancied meeting up for a coffee. Or something.”

I hesitated, unsure of what she was asking. Bedford was only about thirty miles from Cambridge, but it was a long way from Cornwall, where Elena’s husband Tim was. “A coffee?”

She giggled. “Yeah, or whatever. What do you think? Are you free at lunchtime?”

It’d take my full lunch hour to get to Bedford, but that wasn’t actually a problem because we worked flexi-hours, and I could make the time up no problem. “Today?”

“Hmm. What do you think?”

“I...” Pete was definitely listening to my end of the conversation, and the chances were that the other guys in the office were, too. I couldn’t ask Elena if her husband was with her, or if she expected me to bring Suzy with me. “Yeah, okay.”

“Great. How about I research a couple of places and then text you their address.”

“Yeah, that’d work.”

“It’ll only work if you give me your mobile number.”

I hesitated for a moment, then recited my phone number. She repeated it back to me, then said she’d text me soon, and see me later. After she’d ended the call, I put the handset down and stared into space, still a little unnerved by the way she’d tracked me down.

“An acquaintance from Mexico?” Pete asked, smirking.

“What? No!” I laughed and shook my head. “She’s a friend from Cornwall.” I tried to act casual. “She’s lost all the contacts from her phone but remembered where I worked, so tried to get hold of me here.” It was a lie, but Pete nodded like my reasoning made sense. “She’s in Bedford with her job and suggested we meet up for coffee.”

“Right.” Pete grinned. “She sounded hot.”

“She is. Sexy little redhead with a great body.”

He leered. “Nice.”

“Who happens to be married to a six-foot surfer with a muscular beach-bod.”

“Oh.” Pete frowned. He was the weediest guy in our company and probably weighed less than Suzy.

I laughed, then fired up my workstation to check I didn't have any meetings between eleven and two. I didn't. A few minutes later, my phone buzzed in my pocket. I took it out and saw a message from an unknown number with a link and the message '12:30?' I clicked the link, which was for a café. It included the address, and I replied with a thumbs-up emoji. As I went to close the message, it asked me if I wanted to add the number as a new contact. I hesitated for a moment, then added it under the name 'Elena'. I had nothing to hide.

In normal circumstances, I'd have phoned Suzy to ask if she wanted to join me. After all, she knew Elena as well as I did. During our swinging session, Elena had been the first woman to touch Suzy in a sexual way. But phoning my wife wasn't an option when I considered the way our relationship had been over the last week. There was one phone call I needed to make, though.

I stepped out of the office and called the sex-health clinic, arranging an appointment for a check-up. I returned to my desk and rushed through as much of my workload as I could, then headed out to my car at around 11:30. The weather was brighter than yesterday, with the sun breaking through the clouds and warming the air. I took the A428 west to St Neots, which is a picturesque town between Cambridge and Bedford. I realised this would have been a better place to meet, and wished I'd suggested it. Then I headed south and completed the journey to Bedford in good time. After finding a car park, I walked to the café and arrived ten minutes early.

Elena was already there. She stood up and waved, a broad smile on her face. As I approached her table, she stepped close and kissed me on the cheek, curling her arms around my neck. Memories of our only other

meeting flooded my mind. We'd both been naked the last times her arms were around my neck. She'd hoisted herself up and wrapped her legs around my waist, and I'd fucked her standing in the middle of the room.

"Hi." She looked into my eyes and pulled back. "I delayed ordering until you got here, so what would you like?"

"Er, a latte would be good."

She smiled and wandered across to the counter. I watched her from behind. She wore a green silk top, a smart pair of black trousers that hugged her bum, and three-inch heels that probably took her height to five-foot-three. Her dark red hair was pinned up in a messy bun. She looked really sexy.

She came back and slid into her chair opposite mine. "I ordered us a couple of cakes, too."

I was unsure how to start the conversation, but she seemed really relaxed.

"You look good with a tan," she said, smiling.

I laughed. "Thanks."

She scrunched up her nose. "You also looked good without the tan, so that's why I was disappointed when Suzy said you wouldn't be coming over this weekend."

I felt my jaw drop, then tried to recover. "Sorry?"

She'd seen my surprise. "You didn't know that Suzy contacted us yesterday?"

I was too angry to answer.

“That’s what I thought.” She took a breath, but just then the waitress brought over our order. After placing the cups and plates on the table, she gave a smile and left.

“Suzy contacted you via the contact site yesterday?” I asked.

Elena nodded. “She said after your Mexican holiday, you’d decided to have separate meet-ups for a while.”

I nodded, my mind racing.

She picked up her cup and took a sip, then put the cup down again. “Suzy said you lost your heart to the first woman who opened her legs for you.”

The bitch. I tried for a wry smile. “That’s not how I remember it.”

“How do you remember it?” There was a playfulness in her hazel eyes.

“I don’t think our problems started until Suzy got me to lie beneath her and invited three of the waiters to fuck her bareback then come on my dick.”

Now it was Elena’s jaw that dropped.

“Or the night where she went out without me and took at least another dozen men bare.” I was seething inside. “The whole idea of safe sex went out of the window, so if you’re meeting up with Suzy this weekend, I’d recommend you employ condoms.”

Elena seemed to consider all this, then frowned. “But there wasn’t a woman you fell for?”

“The woman she’s referring to is real. She’s an American who asked if we could not use condoms, pointing out she’d already swallowed my load, and Suzy had swallowed her partner’s. The pair of them used condoms with

all other partners including each other. Suzy agreed but later became angry about it. She started referring to her as ‘my girlfriend’ and seemed determined to fuck everyone without a condom as a payback for me.”

“What about you?”

“I used a condom on every woman I fucked except for that occasion.”

“Suzy said you saw her more than once.”

I scoffed and nodded. “I did, and I had to use a condom the second time because it was after Suzy’s deluded idea that I’d *enjoy* having other men come on my dick..”

“So you’re clear of infections?”

“It depends on those three waiters, I guess. I’ve made an appointment for a health check.”

“But if Suzy took on that many, then—”

“I haven’t touched her since the thing with three waiters.”

“Really?”

“Yes. And individual meet-ups is *not* something we’ve discussed.”

While Elena thought about this, I realised how hungry I was. I’d had no breakfast, so I cut the cakes in two and ate half of the donut.

“Are you angry at her for calling us?”

I shrugged. “I’d like to say I’m surprised and disappointed, but I guess I’m only one of those.”

“Would you have joined us if she’d asked?”

I sighed. “Even though I really enjoyed our playdate, I have no interest in swinging with Suzy. Things between us have changed, so I don’t think

watching her slut-act would turn me on at the moment.”

Elena’s eyes went wide. “Wow, things are that bad.”

I nodded. “I’d like to think they’re not irreparable, though. We’ve been together a long time, and I can’t just throw in the towel because she got pissed and took on all-comers.”

She narrowed her eyes. “So you’ve not lost your taste for swinging?”

“Like I said, I’m not sure I’m in the right frame of mind for—”

“What about swinging without Suzy there?”

“Sorry?”

“I have a hotel room a couple of minutes’ walk from here. I have condoms in my handbag, and I’ve wanted to fuck you again since that night in our chalet.”

Despite my best intentions, my cock thickened immediately. “Swinging is about trust,” I said. “You and Tim need to be honest with each other.”

“We will be.” She smiled. “We talked about Suzy’s message last night. I told him I was happy for him to fuck Suzy, but said I wanted to fuck you. He was the one who suggested I come over here and call you.”

“I thought you were working in Bedford for a couple of days.”

She smiled and shook her head. “I lied. You’re my reason for being here. I chose this place because I didn’t know how you’d feel about meeting in your hometown where your friends might see us.”

“How did you find out where I worked?”

She laughed and picked up half of the Eccles cake. “I remembered you said you worked in communications, and I made a list of all the companies

in Cambridge. Then this morning I started to phone around.”

“You came to Bedford anyway?”

She nodded. “Tim suggested if I couldn’t find you, I should pick up a random guy tonight because he has every intention of fucking Suzy on Saturday.”

I thought about it, then frowned. “Are you going to make up a threesome?” I had no idea how easily STDs were transmitted between women during lesbian sex.

“No, I’ll sit that one out.” There were grains of brown sugar around her lips, which she brushed off with delicate fingers. “Will you come back to my hotel after coffee?”

“Yes.” It hadn’t taken much thought.

“Good.” She nodded at the cakes. “Eat more, you’ll need your energy.”

I laughed and picked up the other half of the Eccles cake. We ate and drank in relative silence, then left the café and walked to her hotel, which was an old-fashioned pub with rooms on the upper floors.

As soon as we got into her room, she smiled up at me and removed her top. Her bra was also green, and I saw a matching thong when she unbuttoned her trousers and let them slide down her legs. Without her shoes she was a foot shorter than me. She unpinned her hair and shook it loose, then raised her eyebrows and looked at my shirt.

“I have to undress myself?” I asked.

She nodded, walked over to her handbag and took out a pack of condoms. “Once you’re naked, I’ll dress you in one of these, then the fun can begin.”

I slipped off my shirt, kicked off my shoes and unzipped my trousers, removing my socks as I pulled the pants and shorts off over my feet. Then I stood up straight and smiled, my cock already on its way to a full erection.

Elena wrapped her cool fingers around it. "I remember this," she said, wanking it slowly. "I remember how good it felt inside me, and I remember how hard it shot your spunk down my throat."

My breathing had become shallower. "So do I."

"I wish it could do it again."

I gave a regretful smile. "So do I, but it wouldn't be fair to you *or* Tim."

"I know." She took out a condom and slowly rolled it on. "I guess I'll have to make do with just getting fucked, then."

She sat on the edge of the bed, slipped her fingers into the waistband of her thong and peeled it down her smooth, tanned legs. Still wearing the green bra, she crawled backwards up the bed and let her legs fall open.

I walked over to the bed and ran my fingers over her dainty foot. I could smell her arousal from where I was, and my dick throbbed with need. I knelt between Elena's spread legs and leaned down to inhale her musk.

She gripped my hair. "I don't need foreplay, and I don't want your tongue." She placed her hands on either side of my face. "I want your cock."

I moved up the bed, positioned the tip at her glistening opening and slowly pushed in. She frowned then opened her mouth wide and let out a breathy sigh. My cock slid all the way in until my balls nestled against her arse. I felt her squeeze around me. I pulled back and pushed in again. Elena let out a low moan before placing her hands on my buttocks. I fucked her

slowly and let her dictate the tempo. After a few minutes of going slowly, she started to pull me in faster, raising her body up to meet mine as her moans became more urgent. I felt the clench of her orgasm and she bit into my shoulder. It surprised me but didn't actually hurt much. I returned to the slower rhythm, now pushing deeper and adding a little 'double-tap' at the end of each in-stroke.

Elena opened her eyes and watched my face. She ran a hand through my hair. "Are you going to come yet?"

I smiled and shook my head. Condoms numbed things down, so I always lasted longer when wearing one. "I'm saving it up."

"Is it okay if I come again?"

I smiled and nodded.

"I'm sorry for biting you earlier, I just didn't want the rest of the hotel to hear."

I couldn't remember if she'd bitten me during our date in the cabin, but I had no problem with women biting or scratching me in the throes of passion. "Biting's fine, but nobody knows us here. Scream as loud as you want."

Her eyes fluttered. "Oh fuck." She grabbed my hips and rocked herself against me.

I pushed her bra up to reveal her pert breasts and rolled a nipple between thumb and forefinger.

She cried out when her second orgasm hit. I fucked her through it, kneading her small tits and trapping the nipples between my fingers. When

her moans quietened, she opened her eyes and sighed. “Why haven’t you come yet?”

I laughed and tried to keep the smugness out of my tone. “Staying power.”

“Will you fuck me from behind?”

Like any man would refuse such a request. I pulled out and flipped her over. She quickly got up onto her hands and knees, and I guided my cock back inside her. She let out a groan and rolled her hips. I ran my hand over her bum, then gripped her narrow waist and fucked her hard. She pushed back to meet my thrusts, grunting with each slap of our bodies. My balls swung freely, and she reached back between her legs and caressed them for a short time. Then she released them, and I could feel her fingers against my shaft as I fucked her. She was rubbing her clit, no doubt chasing yet another orgasm.

I decided to help her along. I wet my thumb in her juices, then pushed it up her arse. She squealed, and the clench of her third orgasm was enough to get me over the line. I buried my cock as deep as it could go and closed my eyes. As spasms swept through my body, Elena reached back and cupped my balls in her hand again. She must have felt them jolt with every shot they unloaded.

When my body stopped shaking, I eased out and we fell to the mattress side by side, with me spooning her. Both our bodies were bathed in sweat. I unclipped her bra and she slid it off, then turned around and kissed my neck.

“That made the entire trip here worthwhile,” she whispered, nuzzling the sensitive skin beneath my ear.

I was still a little freaked out that she'd managed to track me down but pleased that she had. "You could have just asked Suzy for my mobile number."

"Why didn't I think of that?" She looked at me. "Will you tell her we've met?"

I nodded. "Things might be strained between us right now, but keeping secrets isn't going to fix things."

She smiled. "Fair enough."

I removed the condom, knotted it and dropped it at the side of the bed. We slipped beneath the cover and lay on cool cotton sheets.

"So," I said, stroking her hair, "how are you and Tim enjoying your swinging adventure?" On our first date, they'd admitted we'd been the first couple they'd met up with via the website.

She smiled and nodded. "It's going okay. Remember we told you we first got into it with our friends, Sammy and Dennis."

I nodded.

"Well, we met up with them again just after our date with you and Suzy. Since then, there's been one other couple from the website." She shrugged, as if embarrassed. "That was another success, I think, though it was much more restrained than our night with you two."

I was curious. "More restrained in what way?"

"No unprotected sex, no girl-on-girl, and no laying the women side by side while the men came over us."

I smiled at the memory. "Yeah, it was fun. Although..." I said, remembering walking back into the room we'd used the following morning.

“I had no idea that anyone walking past the chalet would be able to see in through the huge windows.”

She laughed and shrugged. “What can I say? I’m an exhibitionist.”

We lay in a comfortable silence for a few minutes with her head on my shoulder.

She turned to look at me. “Tell me about the American woman who caused the argument.”

“She didn’t cause the argument,” I said, defensively. “Suzy caused the argument by fucking everyone bareback. She only blamed Cyndi as an afterthought.”

Elena didn’t take sides. “What did she look like?”

Her question surprised me, but I reached over and grabbed my phone from my trouser pocket. I opened my email and brought up Cyndi’s image, then held it up for her to see.

Elena’s eyes went wide. “That’s her?”

I nodded.

“Suzy didn’t mention that she was black.” She frowned and looked closer. “Wow, she’s beautiful.”

I smiled. “Don’t tell Suzy that.”

“Suzy’s beautiful, too. You’re a lucky guy.”

I chewed my lip and pushed the sheet down, revealing her petite body. I traced my hand over the blue Chinese letters of the tattoo on one side of her stomach. “I know another beautiful woman who I’m lucky enough to know.”

She laughed. “Do you mean ‘know’ in the biblical sense?”

“Hmm.” I moved my hand lower and circled her clit with the tip of my middle finger.

“And are you ready to know her again now?” She reached down and gripped my cock, which immediately swelled.

“I think so.”

She rolled onto her tummy and scooted down the bed until her head was level with my hips. Then she raised up on her elbows, leaned over my crotch and smiled.

“Elena—”

“Shh.” She held my cock upright and lowered her head.

As soon as she took it in her mouth, I sighed. But I was worried about passing on infections and pulled her hair. “I thought we’d agreed—”

She released me. “You’re not going to come there, I’m just getting it ready. Once it’s fully hard, I’ll fit another condom and ride it.”

Before I could answer, she’d taken almost my full length back into her mouth and throat. I groaned and pushed my head back into the pillow.

Good to her word, Elena only sucked me for another minute or so. Then she fitted a fresh condom, impaled herself and rode me. After she’d come, I pulled her down on top of me and used my hands to lift and drop her on my body until we both came together.

We lay in the afterglow for several minutes, then I let out a sigh. “I’m going to have to go back to work.”

“I know.” She leaned close and kissed my cheek. “I hope you and Suzy sort things out soon, then you can both visit us for another swap in

Cornwall.”

I smiled and nodded. “I’d like that.”

Once dressed, I left the hotel and found my way back to my car. It was late afternoon by the time I returned to the office, and I knew I’d have to stay a little later to catch up on my work. I didn’t mind one bit.



Ψ



CHAPTER 3

I didn't get home that night until after seven-thirty. Suzy's car was on the drive, and I found her watching some reality TV programme in the living room.

"You're late," she said, not taking her eyes off the screen. The aloofness in her tone annoyed me.

"Yeah, there was something I needed to finish."

"Would it have been too much trouble to text and let me know?"

I frowned. "Sorry, but this morning you didn't seem to know if you'd be in or out tonight, so I assumed it wouldn't be a big deal if I was a bit late."

She shrugged but didn't say more.

I went into the kitchen, which had a dirty pan in the sink. "Have you eaten?" I called.

"I made myself an omelette."

I checked the fridge, which was still pretty empty, then went back into the living room. "I'll go to the supermarket to buy some food." When she didn't look up, I left without another word.

An hour later, I returned with three bags of groceries that included a ready-meal for my dinner, a bottle of white wine and a six-pack of beer. The TV was muted, and Suzy wasn't in the living room or kitchen. As I walked up the stairs, I smelled bubble bath.

I knocked on the bathroom door. "I've bought beer and wine. Do you want anything?"

"A glass of wine, please."

I returned to the kitchen, relieved the wine I'd picked up was from the chilled shelf, and poured her a glass. By the time I made it back upstairs, the door was open a couple of inches. I reached in and held the glass out without actually going into the room itself. Suzy probably thought I was making a point of our current stand-off by not wishing to see her naked, but her attitude earlier had annoyed me. She took the glass from my hand and gave a formal 'thank you'. I went down to the kitchen and put my ready-meal in the oven.

I drank a beer while it was cooking, and another one while I ate. By the time I'd finished, it was about nine-thirty and Suzy hadn't come down. When I went upstairs, I found the bathroom door closed again and called through to ask if she wanted another glass of wine. She declined, so I went into the bedroom, undressed and climbed into bed. I needed a shower and intended taking one as soon as Suzy vacated the bathroom, but I fell asleep before that happened.

When I woke up next morning, I wondered if Suzy had smelled Elena's sex or the condoms on my body. I got up, showered and dressed then went downstairs. In the kitchen I found the empty wine bottle and five empty beer bottles on the counter, of which I'd drunk two. I called up the stairs to let her know I was going, then left for work. It was earlier than usual, but I still needed to make up the hours I'd missed yesterday.

Usually, Suzy and I would exchange numerous texts during the day. Even if nothing major was happening, we'd still keep each other informed of the goings-on at work or whatever. It felt strange to not get them now, but I was just as much to blame because I hadn't texted her.

I still felt guilty for not telling her I'd met up with Elena and decided to rectify that when I got home. At 2pm I told the guys in the office I had an appointment at the dentist. I was actually going to the sexual health clinic, which proved to be less awkward than I'd expected. The guy I saw didn't ask about why I thought I may have contracted something, he just asked general questions, took samples and told me I'd get my results by text. Less than forty minutes later, I returned to the office.

I left work at the normal time and got home before Suzy. The empty bottles were still where they'd been that morning, so I took them out to the recycle bin, then started making a stir-fry. Suzy arrived home fifteen minutes later.

I offered her a smile, but she was frowning at the stir-fry in the pan.

"Sorry," she said, looking guilty. "I've agreed to go out on another bike ride tonight."

I shrugged. She normally would have informed me of that by text, but I didn't mention that. "No problem. I can plate it up so you can reheat it when—"

"No, we agreed to eat out after the ride. Sorry." In fairness, her expression suggested she did feel some guilt.

"Okay. I'll eat as much of it as I can manage and chuck the rest."

As she headed upstairs, I finished off the stir-fry and filled my plate. I grabbed the only remaining beer from the fridge and carried it through to the living room. My plate was almost empty when I heard her coming back downstairs. She wore a fluorescent green lycra top and black cycling shorts with several inches of tanned torso showing between the two garments. Her legs looked amazing, and her hair was pulled back into a ponytail. When I

eyed the sports bag in her hand, she explained she was taking a change of clothes for the post-ride pub visit.

“Right, I’ll see you later,” she said.

I watched her go out to the shed and wheel out her road bike. It took her a few minutes to drop the rear seats in her car and put the bike in, then she got into the car and drove away. Part of me wondered if this was an elaborate charade to make me think she was going out on her bike when in fact she was going for a completely different kind of ride. I chided myself, because I’d done exactly that yesterday and still hadn’t confessed to it.

After a lazy evening watching TV, I headed up to bed at around ten. I managed to read two or three chapters before getting too tired, and I turned the light out at eleven. The sound of Suzy’s car pulling on the drive woke me, but I didn’t turn the light on. Instead, I lay with my back to the bedroom door and maintained my steady breathing. Suzy tiptoed into the bedroom, saw me in bed, and went into the bathroom. A moment later, the shower started running. If she’d been cycling, it was only natural for her to want a shower, but my twisted mind still conjured up more lurid reasons for her need to bathe.

She slipped into bed beside me, turned her back and left a space between our bodies. Although she soon fell asleep, I lay in the dark for a long time before sleep finally came.

* * * *

On Thursday morning, Suzy was up before I woke. I heard her in the kitchen and made my way downstairs. She was already dressed in a t-shirt and a pair of jeans, her regular work-wear.

“You’re up early,” I said.

“We have a 12-hour experiment on today.” Suzy was a biologist at a pharmaceutical research centre. “I agreed to get it started before eight, and one of my colleagues will come in late and stay to take the final readings tonight.”

“Oh, right.” This wasn’t that unusual. “I wanted to talk to you about—”

“Sorry, I really need to get to work.”

I’d wanted to tell her about Elena, but now obviously wasn’t the time. “Okay. Well, I’ll see you later.”

She gave a mirthless smile, picked up her shoulder bag and left. I fixed myself a bowl of cereal and ate it at the kitchen table. Then I went to shower and shave. Twenty minutes later, I left for the office.

* * * *

Suzy’s early start must have allowed her to leave work early, because I arrived home to find her sitting in our small garden with a glass of wine. She gave me a smile and told me there was more beer in the fridge. I headed inside and was pleasantly surprised to smell something good in the oven. I grabbed a beer and headed out to the garden. If I didn’t know that Suzy had secretly arranged to have sex with another man at the weekend, I’d think relations between us were improving.

I lowered myself into the other chair and raised my bottle. “Cheers.”

She smiled and took a sip of her wine.

“How’s the experiment going?” I asked.

She shrugged. “We won’t know that until it’s finished and we compare the data. We’re studying the efficacy of six different drug candidates on the

receptors *in vitro*. Depending on the results, we may move some of them to *in vivo* models in the near future.”

Science was not my forte, and she knew it. “Blah blah blah,” I said, then took a sip of my beer.

She laughed and shook her head. “I’m just trying to expand your mind.”

“Hmm.” I closed my eyes and enjoyed the sunshine for a few moments. It wasn’t that long ago that I’d have suggested she expanded other parts of my body. We weren’t at that stage yet, but this little exchange was the closest we’d been since Mexico. Although I didn’t want to ruin the progress we’d made, I knew I had to tell her about Elena.

“I’ve been thinking,” she said.

I opened my eyes and smiled. “Wow. Was that another experiment?”

“Haha.” She gave a mock frown, and it almost felt like we were us again. “I was thinking that I’d go and visit my parents this weekend.”

Boom! I was suddenly back in our new reality. The lies. The selfishness. The complete violation of trust.

“Your parents?”

She gave a weak smile. “Hmm.”

“But they live a long way from Cornwall.”

Suzy’s eyes went wide with shock, but then they narrowed and all the warmth she’d just feigned was gone. “Have you been reading my—?”

“No.” I shook my head and let out a sigh. “I’ve never snooped, and I don’t intend starting now.”

“So how do you know about—?”

“I got a phone call from Elena.”

Now her eyes were wide again. “She *phoned* you?” She shook her head, clearly confused. “Did you two swap numbers?”

“Of course not. She tracked me down at work.”

Suzy sat forward and put her glass down in the ground next to her chair. “How did she—?”

“Evidently, she’d gleaned enough information from our chat around the firepit at their chalet that night. She knew what I did for a living and that I worked in Cambridge. Her call came through the switchboard.”

“That’s kind of spooky.” Now that her shock had dissipated, Suzy was back to thinking with her analytical brain.

“I know. It goes against all the trust and anonymity of swinging etiquette.”

She nodded, then frowned. “What did Elena say?”

“That she was working in Bedford for a couple of days and asked if I wanted to meet for coffee.”

Suzy’s expression hardened, and she gave a mirthless smile. “You met her.” It wasn’t posed as a question.

I nodded.

“And you fucked her.”

I nodded again.

“And you kept it to yourself.” Her eyes were as cold as I’d ever seen them.

“I was just about to tell you so that you’d feel better about revealing you’d arranged a playdate with Tim.”

“When did you fuck her?”

“Tuesday.”

“The day you got home late.” She nodded to herself. “And then you wait until I lie to spring your little trap, like a fucking weasel.”

“It wasn’t a trap,” I said, annoyed. “On Tuesday night, you stormed off to the bath and stayed there until I was asleep. Last night you went off with your bike and stayed out until I was asleep. When did I have the chance to —?”

“You’ve had two fucking days!” She stood up, grabbed her wine and scowled at me. She shook her head as if rendered speechless, then stomped into the house.

I closed my eyes and let out a sigh. So much for us getting back to normal. I stayed where I was and finished my beer, then headed inside to face the music. Suzy was sitting at the kitchen table eating the dinner she’d prepared.

“Your dinner’s in the oven,” she said. There was a clean plate on the counter, and the oven had been turned down low.

I helped myself to the chicken casserole and jacket potato she’d prepared, then took the chair opposite her. “Thanks.”

She glared at me then shook her head.

I sighed. “Do you want to talk about—?”

“Not really. Why don’t we just do what we’re good at? You fuck who you want, and I’ll fuck who I want.”

“That’s not the way I want us to behave.”

She scoffed. “Easy for you to say now you’ve emptied your sack. Do you expect me to—?”

“I don’t expect anything.” I put my knife and fork down. “I wasn’t the one who contacted one of our swinging couples and asked for a playdate.”

“And yet you still managed to get laid.”

“I believed her when she said she was working in Bedford. I thought we were just meeting up for coffee.”

Suzy studied me for a moment. “So you drove all that way just for a friendly coffee?”

I nodded.

“And when you learned I’d been in touch with Tim, you decided to get even by fucking her first?”

I sighed. “That’s not how it—”

“Bollocks.” She carried her half-finished dinner into the living room, and I heard the TV get turned on.

I stayed in the kitchen and finished my dinner, then opened another beer and went back outside to enjoy the last of the evening sunshine. By the time the sun had dipped behind the neighbour’s house, it was almost seven. I put the garden chairs in the shed and headed back into the house. The TV was off, and Suzy was nowhere to be seen. Assuming she’d gone for another bath, I went upstairs and stopped in my tracks as soon as I reached the landing. Our bedroom door was open, and Suzy was putting clothes into a suitcase on the bed. I took a couple of steps forward and leaned against the door jamb.

She looked up and glared at me. “I’ve taken tomorrow off work so I could have an extra day in Cornwall.”

I was too shocked to admit I’d thought she was leaving me.

“I’m going to take my bike with me,” she said. “I’d like to ride along that coast road we saw.”

Under different circumstances I may have warned against getting too saddle-sore before her playdate.

“I thought if I get packed and put my bike in the car now, then I can leave first thing in the morning to try and avoid most of the rush hour traffic.” When she turned around and opened her chest of drawers. I decided to leave her to it.

I sat in the living room and took out my phone. When I clicked on the email app, there was a new message from Cyndi. A little shiver ran through me, but I decided to delay reading it until I knew Suzy wouldn’t walk in and catch me. I knew that was childish, bearing in mind she was probably packing her silky thong and half-cup bra ready for when she fucked Tim, but for one reason or another, that’s where Suzy and I were at now.



Ψ



CHAPTER 4

When I woke on Friday morning, Suzy was dressed in a pair of cut-offs and a white vest top, showing off her golden tan. Her hair was loose and still damp from the shower. As I sat up, she turned and gave me a half-smile as she put makeup from her dressing table into a small zip-up bag.

“Morning,” she said.

“What time is it?”

“Just after six. I told you I was going to set off early.”

I nodded, got out of bed and pulled on a pair of shorts and t-shirt. “Do you want breakfast?”

“No thanks. I’ve had a cup of tea and might stop for a pastry in a couple of hours.”

I went for a pee. When I returned the bedroom was empty, so I headed downstairs for a coffee. Suzy was putting a couple of final things into a small rucksack. She zipped it up, slung it over her shoulder and stepped toward the backdoor.

“Right, I’ll...” She stopped and stared out through the kitchen window for a moment.

“What?” I said.

She let out a sigh. “Do you remember when things like this turned us on?” Her expression was one of sadness, and I realised she probably longed for things to go back to normal as much as I did.

A lump appeared in my throat, which made it hard to speak. “I—”

“A few weeks ago, you’d have bent me over the counter and fucked me before I left, then done exactly the same when I got home.”

I tried to smile but don't think I managed, so I just gave a helpless shrug instead. Suzy opened the door and left. A minute later, I heard her car drive away.

I rubbed my face, my stubble rasping against my palms. Then I made myself a bowl of cereal and ate it. Remembering Cyndi's unread email, I opened it.

Hey Rob – just a short note to let you know I'm thinking of you.

How are things between you and Suzy? I haven't seen Dean or anyone else since we got back from Mexico. That makes you the last man I had inside me.

When are you going to visit Alabama to take care of my needy pussy?

C xx

I felt my heart race as I read her words. She'd told me she and Dean had split up, but I hadn't been convinced it'd be a permanent split. I knew the two of them used to attend swinging parties together, but it hadn't occurred to me that their split would stop her going to those. I suddenly felt guilty about what I'd done with Elena, which I knew was stupid. The time difference meant it'd still be the middle of the night where she lived, so I sent a short reply suggesting another videocall sometime later. Cereal finished, I headed upstairs to shower and shave. Once dressed, I locked the house and left for work.

A couple of my colleagues were taking the following week off, and they both finished at lunchtime. That left me and a guy called Jamie as the only two in the office for the afternoon. When he suggested we call for a drink after work, I happily agreed. We left at four and walked to the closest pub, which was often full of students. That evening was no exception, and as the

weather was warm and sunny, many of the female students were wearing shorts or short dresses.

Once served, we stood near the bar and Jamie gazed at all the young women. He grinned and leaned closer. "I should come here more often."

"I didn't realise they affected you *that* much."

He looked confused until he finally saw how I'd pretended to misinterpret his words. Then he laughed. "I meant I should *drink* here more often. I haven't *come*, but the night is still young."

I smiled. Jaime was single, but I was pretty sure he was living with a woman called Fleur. The idea of picking up one of these students and spending the night fucking her should have appealed to me but, for some reason, it didn't. In the end, Jamie and I spent almost an hour talking about work, football and other mundane subjects. Then we walked back to the car park at work and went our separate ways. I called for a kebab on the way, then ate it sitting in a deck chair in the garden with a beer.

By the time I sat down in the living room, it was almost seven. I opened my laptop and checked my email. Cyndi had replied.

Hey – a videocall with you would make my day. How about we do it later, when I've finished with all my home students? It'll be six Central Time, so that'll be five or six hours later for you, depending on if you're at GMT or BST. Can you do that with Suzy there?

I smiled as I sent a quick reply, saying we were on British Summer Time with it being summer, and that Suzy was away for the weekend so there'd be no problems at my end. After I'd sent it, I got myself another beer and decided to browse the streaming apps to find something to watch until our videocall.

It was ten past midnight when Cyndi sent an email inviting me to join a call. I clicked and then gasped as she filled the screen. She was naked, sitting with her legs crossed on a hard-backed chair in the middle of her living room.

Her face broke into a beautiful smile at my expression. “Hey, Mister British Summer Time.”

I laughed and shook my head. “Hey, Miss America.”

“How’ve you been?”

I gave a shrug. “I’ve been better.”

She frowned and nodded. “Yeah, me too, I guess. Things still strained between you and Suzy?”

“Yeah.” I smiled. “Are all your clothes in the laundry?”

She laughed and shook her head. “No, I decided that since this was to be the highlight of my weekend, I’d make the most of it.”

“Well, seeing you naked is already the highlight of my weekend.”

“So, where’s Suzy now?”

“Cornwall, which is about as far south and west as you can get in our country.”

“And what’s she doing there?”

“Fucking one of the guys we had a swinging session with before we went to Mexico.”

“Wow.” Her eyes narrowed. “If it was a swinging session, why aren’t you there to satisfy the other woman?”

Here goes. “I fucked her on Tuesday.”

“Oh.” She seemed to think about this for a second, then frowned. “So you and Suzy are now swinging independently?”

I shrugged, then told her how Elena had tracked me down, pretended to be working nearby and suggested a coffee. Then she’d revealed Suzy had asked for another playdate with her husband, and suggested we have ours that day.

Cyndi gave me a smile. “And how was it?”

I frowned and shrugged.

She laughed. “Don’t feel guilty. Tell me the truth.”

“It was good sex with a good-looking woman.” I sighed. “And it was the first sex I’d had since we were in that garden in Mexico.”

She smiled, then blinked. “Did you ever get tested?”

I nodded. “All the results came back clear, but they advised I get re-tested in a few weeks’ time because some infections take longer to show up.”

“So did you use—”

“Yes, I wore a rubber. And I told her why I used a rubber.”

Cyndi nodded. “Do you think Suzy has been tested?”

“I don’t know, but I encouraged Elena to get her husband to use one on their date tomorrow.”

Cyndi frowned. “I thought her date was tonight?”

I shook my head. “It’s tomorrow. She went down a day early so she could do some bike-riding.”

“So what’s she doing tonight?”

“I don’t know.” I sighed, then told her how I’d told Suzy I knew about her upcoming date, and that only then did I confess to meeting Elena.

“How did that go down?” Cyndi asked.

“She called me a fucking weasel.”

“Ouch.”

“Do you have weasels over there?”

She nodded. “We also have fucking weasels. Dean has started taking another woman to the swinging parties. One of the women there called me to ask what’d happened between us.”

“And what did you say?”

“I told her I ended things with Dean because I’d fallen for a white man.”

I felt my jaw drop, and she laughed. Then she slowly uncrossed her legs and let her knees fall open. I stared at her pussy and my cock thickened.

“You’re being unfair,” I said.

“How’s that?” She ran her hand down her tummy and let it rest between her thighs. “You’ve seen another woman since our last time, but I haven’t.”

I sighed, feeling guilty.

“If you were here in Alabama,” she said, her voice a husky whisper. “I’d make you kiss me...” She spread her pussy lips with her fingers. “Here.”

“I’d do that.” I stared at her toned arms and legs, her flat stomach and pert little breasts. “I’d kiss you all over.”

She smiled. “You did that already.”

“I remember.”

“You also fucked my mouth *and* my pussy.”

“I remember that, too.” I grinned. “I also made you come by playing with your nipples.”

Her laugh made my heart ache. “Yes you did.” She leaned forward in the chair, getting closer to her webcam. “Would you like to watch me come now?”

I swallowed. “On one condition.”

She raised her eyebrows. “And what’s that?”

“That you sit so close to the webcam that all I can see is your face.”

“You don’t want to see me play with my pussy?”

“I’d like to see that another time but right now, all I want is to see every expression on your face while you have an orgasm.”

She hesitated for a moment, then got off her chair and dropped to the floor. Then the image shook and settled on just her face. “I’m sitting on the cold floor with my legs under the coffee table,” she said.

“It’s perfect.”

“The floor is uncomfortable.”

I smiled. “I seem to remember you making me lie on a cold tiled floor in the Mexican cabin.”

Now she smiled. “Yeah, that was perfect.”

“Well, I’ve got a great view of your face now, so it’s perfect for me.”

She gave me a mock-frown. “Tell me something sexy to get me in the mood.”

“Whenever I think about our first time together, I get a hard-on.”

She smiled. “Really?”

I nodded. “And whenever I think about our last night in the garden, I masturbate.”

“You think about me when you jerk off?”

I hesitated for a beat, then admitted the truth. “I think about you all the time. I think about you when I’m at work, and I think about you when I’m at home. And yes, I think about you when I jerk off.”

Her face turned suddenly serious. I knew she was pleasuring herself, but I also knew my confession had surprised her. Her breathing became shallow, and she licked her lips.

“What are you thinking about?” I whispered.

“I’m remembering riding your cock as you lay on the floor. I counted down from five so we could come together.”

I smiled at the memory. “We both came when you reached two.”

“Hmm. I felt your cock twitch and knew you were coming in me.”

“I don’t think I’d ever come that hard before.”

“It kept twitching and pulsing, and I felt the heat of your cum inside me. It was...” Her eyes fluttered and then she focused on the camera. “Rob, I’m going to come.”

“Good.”

I watched the changing expressions on her beautiful face. At first she looked like she was trying to recall a long-forgotten memory. Then her expression lightened, and she gave a slightly embarrassed smile before her eyebrows dipped, and her mouth opened wide. The first noise she made was a breathy sigh. Her eyes squeezed shut and she took ragged breaths through

her clenched teeth. Her nostrils flared, then her mouth opened wide, and she let out a low, guttural moan.

Cyndi kept her eyes closed for a few more seconds as her breathing returned to normal, then she opened her eyes and gave the most beautiful, self-conscious smile.

I'd just witnessed one of the sexiest things I'd ever seen. My throat had closed up, my chest was tight, and my cock was throbbing inside my jeans. I was literally speechless.

Cyndi scooted back from the camera and climbed back onto the chair. She stretched her long, shapely legs, and then crossed them again. "Hmm, that's better." She gave an embarrassed smile. "So, how was it for you?"

"It was..." I sighed and smiled. "Breathtakingly sexy."

"Did it make you want to fuck me?"

I shook my head. "It made me want to make love to you."

I was devastated to see a single tear run down her left cheek. Cyndi quickly wiped it away, then gave a short laugh. "I think I needed that more than I realised."

I smiled, but inside I ached to hold and comfort her.

She took a deep breath, sat up straighter and placed her hands in her lap. "So, will you jerk off while I watch?"

I snorted and shook my head. "I'm nothing like as photogenic as you are, and it certainly wouldn't be sexy."

"You let me be the judge of that." She leaned towards the camera again. "I think you're the hottest white man I know."

"Tell me about your day," I said, changing the subject.

“What?”

“Imagine I’m sitting in your living room when you get home. I ask about your day, and you tell me about how little Johnny was a pain in the ass during maths, or little Scarlett was sweet for picking you a flower on the walk to school.”

Cyndi laughed, glanced down at herself, then sighed. “I didn’t get a flower, and everybody is a pain in the ass during math. But little Beatrice didn’t come to school today because her dad was shot when some crackhead held up his store last night.”

“Jeez.”

“He’s not dead. The culprit, who turned out to be a fourteen-year-old boy, shot him in the leg when he tried to reason with him. And Brandon didn’t come to school today because his mom was beaten up by her latest boyfriend.”

There was a sadness in her big brown eyes, and I worried that this videocall wasn’t going as well as I’d planned. “When I think about your hometown, I imagine white picket fences, old people sitting out on their porches, and laughing children chasing each other in the park.”

“It can be like that, but there’s another side too. A side that isn’t quite so idyllic.”

“So,” I said, trying to lighten the mood, which had turned a little too sombre. “What are you going to do for the rest of your evening?”

Cyndi shrugged, then stood and picked up a pale cream dress. She stepped into it and buttoned it up the front, not bothering with underwear. “I

guess now that I've scratched my horny itch, I'll make myself something to eat, then watch a movie. What about you?"

"It's late here, so I'll be going to bed."

She nodded as she dropped back into the chair. "I guess Dean will be driving his new lady friend to Montgomery tonight. They'll stay in a cheap hotel and fuck like rabbits, then tomorrow night they'll attend a swinging party."

"I suspect Suzy will have gone out in whatever town she's staying in tonight and picked up somebody to fuck, then tomorrow she'll be driving to the beach chalet we visited before and giving herself to the surfer guy who fucked her before."

"Does it bother you?" Cyndi asked.

I shook my head. "The only part that bothers me is that you're four thousand miles away."

She held my gaze for a moment then sighed. "I still wish you'd jerked off so I could watch."

"How about I refrain from having another orgasm until I see you again?"

She gave a rueful smile. "I don't think either of us believe that."

I just stared at her face on the laptop screen, my heart crashing in my chest.

"Well," she said, uncrossing her legs and leaning forwards. "If Suzy is away for the whole weekend, can we have another videocall tomorrow?"

"Yes please."

We said our goodbyes, and Cyndi ended the call. I closed down my laptop, turned off all the lights and went upstairs. After visiting the bathroom I climbed into bed and lay in the dark thinking about Cyndi. Even though watching her masturbate had made me horny as hell, I didn't touch myself. A little part of me was determined to keep my promise about not coming until I saw her again.

* * * *

Saturday night's videocall with Cyndi was more relaxed and less emotional. She'd set her laptop up in a different room, which she referred to as her den. And she was dressed in a pair of cut-off jeans and a bright yellow vest top that showed her nipples pressing against the soft cotton.

"I like your vest," I said as she smiled at me.

She laughed and tilted her head to one side, which she did a lot. "You asking to see my nipples, Rob?"

"Would you show them to me if I did?"

She chewed her lower lip, then shrugged. "I think I'd do anything you asked."

A shiver ran down my spine, and then I noticed a piano against the back wall. "You'd do anything?"

She smiled and shook her head. "I should have said anything within reason, but considering what I did last night..." She gave another beautiful smile.

"Play something on the piano for me."

Her eyes went wide, then she laughed. "Seriously?"

"Yep."

Cyndi picked up her laptop and carried it over towards the piano. She placed it on something – maybe a dresser or side-table – so I was watching her from the side. Leaning against a different wall was an acoustic guitar I hadn't seen earlier. She ran her right hand over a few keys, playing what sounded like a scale exercise, then turned to look at her webcam. "What do you want me to play?"

"Anything."

She frowned, turned towards her piano and brought both hands up to the keyboard. Then she began to play a classical piece I recognised but couldn't name. After a minute she stopped and turned towards the camera.

"Play another," I urged.

She smiled and turned back to the piano. She played another classical piece I'd heard before. Then after a minute or so, she changed to a song I did recognise. It was the jaunty song that I knew was called 'I've Got Rhythm'.

Finally, she spun on her piano stool to face the camera. "Well?"

I smiled. "I recognised them all, but I only know the title of the last one."

"The first two were Beethoven pieces, Fleur-de-Lis and Moonlight Sonata. The one you knew was by George Gershwin."

"And now I want to hear you play your guitar."

She groaned and shook her head. "Is this an audition?"

"No, it's me being impressed by your talents."

She got up and walked over to pick up her guitar. She returned to her stool, sat down and played the strings one at a time, tuning each and re-

hitting it until satisfied. Then she played a final chord. She smiled up at the camera. “I’ll play a request if you promise to jerk off for me.”

I laughed and shook my head. “I thought we’d already agreed that I’d save it until I see you.”

“You’d drown me in cum if you try that. Or explode on the flight here, covering all the other passengers in your pent-up goo.”

I laughed at the image. “Play anything. I just want to watch your fingers move and pretend they’re touching me.”

Cyndi sighed, then smiled. “I sometimes take this to school and play for the kids. There’s one song they like me to play. A cover of it was a big hit over here a couple of years ago, but it’s an old song by an English musician, Tracy Chapman. Do you know of her?”

I shook my head.

She picked something up from the top of the piano and fitted it onto the fretboard, plucked each string again to check the tuning, then began to play. Her fingers moved fluidly over the strings, picking individual ones with her right and pressing the fretboard with her left. Then she began to sing. “*You got a fast car, I want a ticket to anywhere.*”

I stared in awe. Her voice was pitch perfect and crystal clear. I knew nothing about guitar playing, but hers sounded fantastic to me.

She kept her eyes down until she got to the line, “*I-I had a feeling I could be someone, be someone, be someone.*” That’s when she looked up into the camera and I realised with a kick to my stomach that she was the woman I wanted to be with.

She stopped playing and gave a modest shrug. “I love that song.”

The lump in my throat stopped me telling her that I loved her, which was probably a good thing. I swallowed, then shook my head. "I had no idea you were so talented."

She laughed and put her guitar down but stayed on the piano stool. "You thought I was just a fine piece of ass who liked to fuck?"

"That's not how I'd have put it, but..." I shrugged, then frowned. "Are you finding it a struggle not to fuck?"

She looked up to the ceiling, then shook her head. "No. In the last three years I've probably fucked more men than most women fuck in a lifetime, so I was due a rest."

Jealousy pierced my heart. "How many men have you fucked?"

"I stopped counting a long time ago."

"Roughly?"

She sighed, then took a breath. "Well, in Mexico I had sixteen. The year before at the resort, I had fourteen. Every time we went to a swinging party I had at least two, sometimes three." Her face took on a sad expression. "I suppose I'm what most people would call damaged goods."

I smiled and shook my head. "You're not damaged. And I should know, I've tried the goods out for myself."

She laughed. "You were the last man to try them out."

We stared at each other in silence for a moment, then she ran her hand through her short hair. "Did you hear from Suzy today?"

"No, she'll have been too busy."

"Will she be with her man now?"

It was ten-thirty in the UK. “Yep. She probably has her legs spread wide and a cock buried deep inside her at this very minute.”

“Do you care?”

“No.”

“Does it turn you on?”

“No, and the sad thing is, I’m more disappointed about it not turning me on than I am about not caring.”

“What are you going to do?” Cyndi looked genuinely concerned.

“I don’t know.”

“Maybe you can fix it.” She shrugged. “If you think these videocalls are stopping you fixing things with Suzy, we should stop them.”

“I don’t want to stop them.” The thought of losing contact with Cyndi felt like a kick in the gut, but it had to be a two-way thing. “Do you think you’d find it easier to move on to another fuck-buddy if we stopped calling each other?”

“I don’t want another fuck-buddy.”

I wanted to ask what she *did* want. I also wanted to tell her that I wanted her, but in the end I just studied her face and wished I could kiss it.

After we’d said our goodbyes, I sat in a kind of daze staring at the screensaver on my laptop. Cyndi’s piano and guitar playing had impressed me as much as her orgasm had during our previous videocall.

Well, almost.



Ψ



CHAPTER 5

I was reading a novel in our living room when Suzy arrived home on Sunday afternoon. She walked in and gave me a half-smile, then carried her bag upstairs. I heard the bathroom door lock, and a minute later the chain flushed.

She returned to the living room and stopped on the rug in front of my chair. “Want a coffee?”

I smiled and nodded, and she disappeared into the kitchen. When she came back I put my book down and took the proffered cup. “Thanks,” I said.

She sat on the couch and studied me. “How was your weekend?”

“Quiet. I went for a drink after work with Jamie, other than that I didn’t do much.”

She nodded, obviously waiting for me to ask questions.

“Did you find time to cycle on the coast road?”

She nodded. “I hadn’t realised just how many hills there were, but yeah. It was good.”

I felt uncomfortable under her gaze. Even though I’d told Cyndi the truth about not caring or being turned on by whatever Suzy had been doing, I was still curious. “So, how was your weekend?”

She took a breath then shrugged. “Do you really want to know?”

“I promise not to be upset.”

That seemed to piss her off. “Okay. On Friday night I went to a bar and picked up a kid who was barely twenty. I took him back to my hotel and

gave him the night of his life. On Saturday, Tim had asked if I wanted him to invite his friend Dennis along.”

I remembered Tim and Elena telling us they’d first swapped with their friends Dennis and Sammy. “His surfer buddy who’d gotten them into swinging?”

She nodded. “I said yes, obviously, and I had a great time.”

Even though there were a hundred questions running through my head, I didn’t voice any of them.

She smiled knowingly. “I had them one at a time, and I had them both together. I was the dirty little pig on their spit-roast, and I was the succulent meat in their sandwich.”

I knew my mouth was open, but I couldn’t think of anything to say.

Suzy put her cup down and stood up. “I think I deserve a biscuit, because all I’ve had to eat today is a bowl of muesli and a mouthful of cum.” With that, she went to the kitchen and returned with a packet of chocolate biscuits. She offered me one but I shook my head, trying not to let her see I was aroused by her disclosure.

Once our coffees were finished, I helped her lift the bike out of her car. While she hosed it clean, I started to make dinner. We ate in the living room watching TV and, unsurprisingly, Suzy said she was tired and headed up for a bath and then bed shortly after we’d finished eating. I stayed up late, imagining my wife being fucked all night long by two men. At least one of them had spent the night in the chalet because she’d told me he’d come in her mouth the next morning, though I knew she might have told me a complete pack of lies just to get a reaction.

Suzy was sleeping soundly when I eventually went to bed. As had now become our norm, there was a gap between us in the bed that never seemed to close while we slept.

I got up and showered as soon as I woke up. As I was getting dressed for work, I saw Suzy watching me from the bed. “Do you want a cup of tea?” I asked.

“No thanks.” She sat up and stretched. She was topless, and her big, firm tits looked inviting. She left them exposed for a few seconds, then pulled the quilt up to cover them. “We’re carrying out another twelve-hour experiment today. I’m doing the late shift, so I’ll go in at lunchtime but won’t get home until about nine.”

“Okay.” I gave her a friendly smile and left for work.

Suzy and I saw little of each other for the rest of the week. On Tuesday evening she went out for her usual ride with her cycling club, and on Wednesday I worked a little later than usual then went to the supermarket to get some groceries. The first evening we were both in the house for any length of time was Thursday, and just after dinner, Suzy announced she was going to the spare bedroom to train on the exercise bike we kept in there.

I half-watched TV while surfing the web with my laptop on my knee. Cyndi hadn’t emailed since Saturday, and I longed for another message. When I heard the change in rhythm of Suzy’s pedalling, I knew she was doing the cooldown that signalled the end of her session. Since I fancied a beer, I wondered if she was ready for a drink and went up to ask.

Pushing the door open, I leaned my head into the room. “I’m having a beer and wondered...”

I was momentarily struck by how fabulous she looked. Her hair was tied up in a high ponytail, and she wore a skimpy pair of shorts and matching sports bra with a halter neck. Most of her body was exposed — her legs, arms, shoulders, shoulder blades and midriff. Her tanned skin was beaded with sweat.

She saw me staring at her and gave a little smile. “A beer while I have a bath would be good. Thanks.”

I headed to the kitchen, angry at myself for leering at her body. After opening two beers, I put one on the coffee table and took the other upstairs. Suzy was walking across the landing, her feet now bare because she kept her training cycling shoes next to the exercise bike.

She smiled up at me as she took the beer. “Thanks.”

I returned her smile.

“By the way,” she said. “I’m going away again this weekend.”

I hesitated, then nodded. “Okay.” Maybe this time she really was going to see her parents.

She gave a smirk. “The answer to your unasked question is ‘yes’. I’ll be sleeping with another man.”

After giving a curt nod, I returned to the living room. A couple of minutes later, I heard the bathroom door close and lock. Beer finished, I got myself another and had soon drunk that one. I turned off the TV and headed up to bed, unable to use the bathroom to brush my teeth because Suzy was in the bath. I tried reading in bed but couldn’t concentrate, and after needing to go back to re-read the previous page to try and follow the plot, I put the

book down and turned the light off. Sleep had taken me before Suzy came to bed.

On Friday morning I left for work without waking Suzy. Since Jamie and I had spent the entire week with just the two of us in the office, I suggested we revisit the pub full of students after work on Friday evening. As we were chatting and enjoying the view of undergraduate hotties, I felt my phone vibrate in my pocket. I took it out and saw a text from Suzy. It was the first I'd received from her in a long time. I opened it.

Looks like you're not coming home anytime soon, so I'll see you on Sunday.

The coldness of her message made me sad rather than angry. She used to sign off with a couple of kisses or a heart emoji. Those days were gone.

I replied that I'd been held up at work as two members of our office were on holiday. It was a lie and, after sending it, I wished I'd taken a photo of the sexy young brunette standing near the bar and told Suzy I was just lining up a playdate of my own. We left the pub and once in my car, I decided to eat out rather than get a takeaway. Twenty minutes later, I was in a curry house in one of the small satellite towns around Cambridge. Only three other tables were being used, one by a middle-aged couple, and the other two by groups of young men. As I ate, I checked my emails and seeing there was still nothing from Cyndi, I sent her a short message saying I'd be spending another weekend alone and would welcome another videocall. I hadn't received a reply by the time I'd eaten my chicken jalfrezi and keema naan, so I paid my bill and bought another six-pack of beers on my walk back to my car.

Once home, I changed into a pair of sweatpants and t-shirt, put the new beers in the fridge and opened an already chilled one. I dropped into the

armchair, picked up my laptop and opened my email. I felt my face break into a smile when I saw an email from Cyndi, but my smile disappeared as soon as I opened her message.

Sorry, but I won't be able to do a videocall tonight. I've had some bad news and won't be home for a few days. I'll email as soon as I can.

Cyndi xxxxx

Although I was worried about what bad news Cyndi might have received, and disappointed about the absence of a videocall, the simple fact she'd added so many kisses made me smile. Coming so soon after Suzy's cold one-liner, the difference in tone of the two messages spoke volumes.

I spent the evening reading and drinking beer. I finished the book and saw there was a sequel available, so I ordered that one. I felt bloated by the curry and naan I'd eaten earlier, not to mention the beer in the pub and the three I'd drunk at home. Shortly after ten I went upstairs, stripped naked and stepped into the shower. Then I went to bed and tried not to think about what my wife was doing over the weekend.

I woke early on Saturday morning and headed downstairs to make myself a coffee. I checked my email as the kettle was boiling, and when I saw one from Cyndi, I opened it immediately.

Hey – Sorry about yesterday's short and confusing reply. While I don't have time for a videocall, I now have time to write and explain things.

My dad was killed in a road accident yesterday. We weren't close - he left when I was five years old and never provided my mom with any financial support. I didn't see him for sixteen years - but we met again a few years ago. He remarried and had another child, a ten-year-old boy who has autism and other learning difficulties.

I've offered to help his widow with the funeral arrangements, and then she's going to move to Georgia to be near her own family, so I guess I'll be seeing a lot less of my half-brother.

I should be back home in a couple days, when I'd love a videocall.

Cyndi xx

I was shocked and typed out a quick response.

Hi Cyndi

So sorry to hear about your dad. Getting limited contact with your half-brother must also hurt.

Good luck with the funeral arrangements. I'll be thinking of you. Rob xxxx

Once I'd sent the email, I took my coffee through to the living room and read the news and football updates on my phone. I felt lethargic and unmotivated, so it was an effort to make myself get dressed and brush my teeth. Not bothering to shave, I returned downstairs and made myself a slice of toast and another coffee while I tried to decide what to do with my weekend. Knowing how Suzy was spending her weekend, I felt no obligation to spend mine doing housework, gardening or other chores, though I couldn't remember the last time I'd cleaned my car. Decision made, I drove to the local hand car-wash and asked them to give it a mini-valet. Then I wandered around the shops and called for yet another coffee. When I returned to pick up my car, it gleamed on the outside and was pristine and sweet-smelling inside. I paid the thirty-five pound fee and also gave the kid who'd worked on it a five pound tip.

By the time I returned home, I found that the book I'd ordered just over twelve hours earlier had already been delivered. I kicked off my shoes,

dropped onto the couch and re-immersed myself in the fictional world of Mark Billingham's fabulous Blackpool detective, Declan Miller.

By mid-afternoon I was restless and hungry. The clouds that had hidden the sun earlier had dispersed, giving way to a warm, sunny afternoon. It would have been easy to succumb to yet another pub meal and a couple of hours in a beer garden, but I remembered how bloated I'd felt after my curry and beer the previous evening. Instead, I walked along to the local shops and bought some freshly baked bread rolls. Once back home, I made myself a couple of ham and tomato rolls which I ate in the garden with a bottle of sparkling water.

The new football season had started, so I headed back inside to watch the early evening match on TV. After that had finished, I checked my email to see if Cyndi had written again, then read more of my book. I headed up to bed a little before eleven and finished the novel. I knew the third book in the series wouldn't be published until the following year. After I turned out the lamp, I lay in the dark and wondered how Cyndi was getting on with her late father's widow and the funeral arrangements. Strangely, I couldn't care less about what my wife was doing with whomever she was giving herself to at that moment.

* * * *

I woke early, as usual. I eventually got up a little after seven and was reading the news on my phone while drinking my second cup of coffee when the doorbell rang.

Puzzled, I put my phone down and went to answer the door. I was shocked to see my old army buddy Stig and his wife Mandy on the

doorstep. I knew they were going to Italy soon and wondered if we'd discussed them calling here on their way to the airport.

"Hi guys," I said, but then I saw their expressions. "Is everything okay?"

"No it fucking isn't," Mandy said.

I'd never seen her look so angry. When I glanced up at Stig, he looked contrite. I stepped back into the hall and motioned for them to come in. Mandy walked past me and straight into the living room. Stig and I followed.

"She knows about Yorkshire," Stig said.

Yorkshire, when Suzy had given me and my three army buddies free-use of her body for the weekend. I frowned, then turned to Mandy. I could see that beneath her ire, there was a lot of hurt.

"I'm sorry, Ma—"

"You've got nothing to be sorry for." She glared at Stig. "It's him who should be sorry. He's the one who broke the vows he'd made in church."

Stig lowered his gaze to the floor.

I ran my hand over my face. I hadn't shaved since Friday, so probably looked like a homeless man. "Er, Suzy isn't here at the mom—"

"Yes, we know that." Mandy was still glaring at her husband.

I was confused. Even though her anger wasn't directed at me, I worried about Stig and felt compelled to defend him. I turned to Mandy. "The Yorkshire thing wasn't planned. *You* were supposed to have been coming as well. If we'd known you couldn't make it, Suzy would have stayed here, and we'd have had a boys-only weekend."

“It sounded like you had quite the boys’ weekend anyway,” Mandy snarled. “Beer, cards and blowjobs.”

Why the fuck had Stig owned up?

I was embarrassed that our selfishness had caused so much pain to someone who’d done nothing wrong. “Mand, what happened that weekend was just a—”

“Fuck-fest?” She wasn’t letting me explain, and I could see she was actually shaking with rage.

I frowned, then shook my head. I was as guilty as Stig because I’d encouraged him to fuck my wife. “Can I get you two a coffee or anything?”

Mandy glared at Stig, then turned back to me and smiled. “Coffee would be nice, Rob. Thank you.”

I let out a quiet sigh of relief. I’d always liked Mandy and had known her as long as Stig had. She’d been an army nurse in Afghanistan, and I’d always found it amazing that such a big personality could fit into such a small body. Exactly five feet tall, she was very petite except for her boobs, which may have been a regular size but looked bigger on her tiny frame. She had a pretty face and big, sparkling blue eyes.

“So,” I said, re-boiling the kettle as the two of them stood just inside the kitchen door. “The weekend in Yorkshire was probably a result of Suzy and I having just gotten into something that at the time seemed like fun, but with hindsight was definitely a mistake.”

“Yeah, it was clearly a mistake,” Mandy said.

I paused while reaching to get two mugs from the cupboard.

“You don’t know, do you?” Mandy stepped closer, her eyes on mine.
“She didn’t tell you.”

I shook my head, wondering what she was talking about.

“Last night was the reunion for the Somalian drinking station,” Stig explained. “Suzy was there as Terry’s plus one.”

A coldness gripped my stomach. Terry had been another of my ex-army friends who’d been in the cottage in Yorkshire.

“Suzy turned up as Terry’s date at a reunion of my old army squad?” I couldn’t believe it.

Stig nodded.

“Her dress was inappropriately short,” Mandy said. “And she was draped all around him all night. It was obvious she wasn’t just making up the numbers because he’s single.”

My mind was racing. “So did *she* tell you about Yorkshire?”

Mandy shook her head. “I didn’t actually speak to Suzy, and I insisted we leave as soon as the dinner was finished.” She nodded in Stig’s direction. “I made him tell me everything once we got back to our room.”

“Where was it at?”

Stig named a hotel I’d never heard of, and when I shook my head, he added, “It’s in Kensington.”

“So you’ve driven here from London this morning?”

He nodded.

“I didn’t want to risk seeing them at breakfast after finding out what happened on that weekend.” Mandy shook her head. “What the fuck

happened to you two? I always thought you and Suzy had a great relationship.”

I passed them their drinks and nodded towards the door. We all headed back into the living room. I took the armchair, Mandy and Stig took the couch.

“This probably sounds like a bit of a cliché, but you could say we played with fire and ended up burning the marriage to the ground.”

“You’ve split up?” Stig sounded shocked.

I frowned as the reality actually hit me. “I honestly can’t see any way for us to stay together after this.” I saw my friend and his wife exchange a look.

“But if she’s slept with Terry before, what’s the problem?” Mandy said.

“The last time was during a weekend of hijinks. It was... I *thought* it was an isolated incident, a once-in-a lifetime thing that’d never be mentioned again.”

“But you went to a couples’ resort.” Mandy seemed confused by my reasoning.

“Yes, where we fucked total strangers. What we do for kicks should never have included our friends. That weekend was a spontaneous thing that I now see never should have happened.” I shrugged and nodded at Stig. “He was against it at the start. Everyone railroaded—”

“Bollocks!” Mandy rasped. “He was as guilty as the rest of them. Even more so, because he was married.”

I nodded. Although I didn’t know how much Stig had owned up to, I certainly didn’t intend mentioning the fact he’d come in all three of Suzy’s

holes as well as blasting his load in her face after he and I had spit-roasted her.

“And that is why,” Mandy said, “I want you to fuck me.”

“What?”

She nodded at her husband. “I want him to know what it feels like to know their spouse has had sex with someone you considered a friend.”

I gave a weak smile and shook my head. “Mand, I can’t sleep with you.”

“Who said anything about sleep. I want you to fuck me while he watches. I want him to see me enjoy sex with somebody he likes.”

I shook my head. “I regret what happened in Yorkshire, but two wrongs don’t make a right.”

Mandy stood up and started to undo the buttons of her shirt.

“What are you doing?” I asked.

“I’ve seen the way you look at me.” She pulled the tails of her shirt out of her jeans and opened the final buttons. This was so out of character for her, and I was ashamed that I had forced her into this by what I’d agreed to in Yorkshire.

I now had a clear view of her tits in the lacy pale blue bra, and her flat stomach. “Mandy, stop.”

“I know you’ve always fancied me. If you think your guilt will stop you getting hard, I have tricks that could—”

I stood up and stepped close. I placed my finger over her lips, then glanced down at her sexy body. “This isn’t going to happen, but it’s nothing to do with guilt or not fancying you.” I moved my hands down and fastened

a couple of her shirt buttons. “You’re right. I think you’re one of the most attractive women I know, but it goes beyond that. I love you as a friend, and I really value that friendship.” I nodded towards Stig. “Just like I value his. I won’t hurt him to help you get even.”

Mandy chewed her lip, her eyes glistening with tears.

“In thirty years’ time,” I continued, “I’d like us three to be able to sit in deckchairs on the beach in Llandudno and reminisce about the fun we had when we were young. I don’t want there to be any resentment between us.”

Mandy frowned as if confused. “But he fucked your wife.”

I nodded. “And I feel no resentment about it.”

“He cheated on me.”

“I know, and I appreciate you feel hurt by that. But it was just sex. There were other men there, and it was all one big...” I shrugged. “It *was* a fuck-fest. But it wasn’t an intimate thing that you should be jealous of. Fucking Suzy that weekend was probably nothing more than having a wet wank for everyone. There was no emotional connection, it was just a matter of using her body to get off.”

She looked down at Stig then closed her eyes. He reached up and gripped her hand, and I saw her squeeze it back.

Then she looked up at me. “You’re the first man to ever turn me down.”

I opened the top of her shirt, looked down at her boobs and blew my cheeks out. “And I’ll probably kick myself for it later.” I smiled, wrapped my arms around her and kissed the top of her head. “If you’d made the offer in Afghanistan before my best friend fell in love with you, I’d have happily fucked your brains out.”

She held my gaze for a moment, and I felt my cock stir. Then she dropped onto the couch and elbowed her husband. “Pass me my coffee.”

I checked my watch; it was still early. “What are your plans for today?”

Stig shrugged. “We’d planned to have breakfast at the hotel, then spend the day in London before driving back to Wrexham later this afternoon.”

“How about I get dressed, then we can all go into town and have some breakfast?”

They both nodded, so I headed upstairs. By the time I returned, showered, shaved and dressed, Mandy had washed the mugs and left them on the draining board. We decided to take both cars, then they could head straight for the motorway while I returned home.

We wandered around the streets of Cambridge, passing the magnificent old university buildings until we found a small café serving food.

Once we’d ordered, I asked about the reunion. “Who else was there, then? I assume Flynn couldn’t make it.” Flynn had been the other of my army friends to attend the weekend in Yorkshire with Terry and Stig. He was the only one of us still in the service and was currently stationed in the Middle East.

“Nah, he’s still in Oman.” Stig reeled off a list of men I remembered. “None of the guys there were still in the army.”

“Did Terry get the job on the oilrig?” I remembered him saying he’d applied for one.

“I wasn’t allowed to talk to him.” He glanced at Mandy.

“I was livid,” she admitted. “When I saw Suzy, I thought maybe you’d decided to come after all. I was all happy, then I saw she was with Terry

and..." She shook her head. "The guy is such a fucking lech. What does she see in him?"

Stig and I exchanged a look.

"Oh, I know all about his big cock," Mandy said. "Trust me, it'd take more than that to make me spend any time with him."

I laughed.

"So," Stig said quietly. "What are you going to do about... You know, about her seeing Terry."

I shook my head. "Things haven't been right for a while. I told you about Mexico?"

He nodded.

"But this is..." I put my knife and fork down, appetite gone. "For her to turn up at a party full of the people I served with is a slap in the face. It shows she doesn't care about my feelings. It shows she doesn't really care about anything except satisfying her needy twat."

Mandy giggled, then turned serious. "Where did she tell you she was going?"

"She didn't." I shrugged. "I know she spent last weekend in Cornwall with another man." I didn't clarify that by saying she'd since confessed to sleeping with three men while there, one on Friday night, and two at the same time on Saturday. "And she told me she was going away with another guy this weekend."

"What about you?" Mandy asked. "Are you seeing other women?"

I thought about Elena and nodded. Then I thought about Cyndi and felt an ache inside. "I met an American woman in Mexico. Suzy blames her for

everything that's gone wrong in our marriage."

"Why does Suzy blame her?" Stig asked. "I thought she'd gone bareback riding with all and sundry?"

"She did, but she claims she only did that because I did it with the American woman first."

Stig and Mandy exchanged another look, then waited.

I shrugged. "I knew she was safe. And there'd already been oral, anyway. She sucked me off while Suzy sucked her partner off."

Mandy's eyes went wide.

"Sorry, TMI?" I shrugged. "Anyway, that was the start of the downward spiral, and I think we've finally reached the bottom of the slide."

"So what are you going to do?" Stig asked.

"There's nothing else I can do." I thought of all the guys I'd served with whispering about my wife being all over one of my closest friends. "What she did last night is the final nail in the coffin of our marriage."



Ψ



CHAPTER 6

Once breakfast was finished, the three of us wandered around Cambridge for another hour or so, then headed back to the cars. Stig and Mandy said their goodbyes and started the drive back to their home in North Wales. I left my car where it was and wandered down towards the River Cam. It was a nice sunny day, and I needed time to think.

I was relieved that Stig and Mandy seemed to be okay in their relationship, though it would probably take Mandy a while to forgive what her husband had done during that weekend in Yorkshire. My own admission in the café about this being the end of my marriage weighed heavily. Although splitting up had been on my mind since Mexico, that was the first time I'd said it out loud. Now I had to face up to the reality of getting a divorce, selling the house and dividing the assets.

Was I overreacting? Like Mandy had pointed out, Suzy had slept with Terry in the past — with my full blessing — so was last night really such a big deal? Even though our first non-monogamous adventure had been instigated by Suzy at a student party months earlier, it had been a joint decision for us to start swinging. I'd known there was the potential for things to go wrong but had gone along with it anyway. As I'd pointed out to Stig in a phone call just a couple of weeks earlier, I'd played with fire and eventually gotten burned.

I thought about the other women I'd had sex with. Railing Amanda as she hung off the end of their sofa with Amanda's husband and Suzy watching; standing up in the Cornwall chalet and bouncing tiny Elena on my cock; lying on a wooden lounge on a beach in Mexico and letting fifty-year-old Lynne ride my cock, first with her pussy, then with her arse;

bending Daisy over the bed and fucking her roughly because I didn't actually like her; slamming into Frankie and watching her voluptuous body ripple from my thrusts; being with Cyndi under the tree draped with fairy lights. Suddenly, the only images in my mind's eye were of her. Talking, smiling, or eyes closed in ecstasy, Cyndi's face was all I could see.

A dog chased past me and ran into the river, scattering the ducks who'd been serenely gliding through the water. I smiled as I watched the birds flap their wings and scatter across to the far side before settling themselves back on the surface. The dog turned around and swam back to its owner, obviously pleased with itself. I turned around and headed back to my car.

I was surprised to see Suzy's car on the drive when I got home. I parked my car behind hers and went into the house, dreading the confrontation.

Suzy was in the living room, sitting on the couch wearing a pair of shorts and one of my t-shirts that was far too big for her. She smiled, but her smile faded when she saw my expression.

"What is it?" she asked.

"What do you think?" I said, standing a few feet inside the door.

She shrugged, evidently oblivious to what she'd done wrong.

"I'll give you a clue. How did you spend your weekend?"

Now a half-smile returned. "Well, I got a phone call from one of the guys I'd already slept with. He asked me if I fancied meeting up because he had a party in London to attend. I knew from experience that he has a huge cock, and when he told me he'd been working on an oilrig in the middle of the North Sea for two months, it seemed too good an opportunity to miss." She bobbed her eyebrows. "All that tension he must have built up."

“And it didn’t occur to you that everyone else at that party were guys I’d served in the army with?”

She frowned. “The only guys you still see from those days are Terry, Stig and Flynn, and we both know what happened when we last got together.”

“So if I went to a party full of all your work colleagues and fawned all over one of the other women, you wouldn’t have a problem?”

“That’s not the same thing.” She sat forward. “But if you did it at a party full of my old university classmates who I no longer see, I wouldn’t have a problem with it, no.”

“What about Stig and Mandy? How could you do that in front of them? You knew Mandy was unaware of what went on in Yorkshire. How could Stig explain your actions away without admitting what had gone on before?”

She shook her head and shrugged. “We’ve met them since, when they came to Cambridge for his conference. There was no problem then.”

I scoffed. “No, because we acted like a normal couple. We went out as a foursome, had a drink and talked about regular stuff. But last night, you couldn’t even behave like you were just making up numbers and save the smuttiness until you got to your hotel room. I hear you wore a slutty dress and draped yourself all over him.”

She looked down at her bare feet and shrugged. “I don’t think their relationship is my problem. Stig said he thought she was fucking around when—”

“She wasn’t. She thought Stig was under stress at work. The only problem they had was a communication one. But now, she knows about your appetite for fresh cocks.”

Suzy shrugged. “All I did was spend a couple of nights with a guy you were happy for me to fuck a couple of months ago. I don’t see what I’ve done wrong.”

“Well I do.” I stepped closer, making her need to tilt her head back to look up into my face. “We said if this wasn’t working for both of us, we’d stop. Well it’s not working for me, but I now know that you have no intention of stopping.”

She frowned and shook her head. “So what are—?”

“I’ve had enough. I’m done with the swinging, and I’m done with a wife who only cares about herself.”

Suzy laughed and leaned back. “Is this about you not getting enough sex?” She bent one leg and brought her foot up onto the seat, then let her knee fall open. “I told you before that if you struck out, I’d fuck you and give you the details of my evening.”

I glared at her, too shocked to say anything. Then I shook my head and walked back to the door. “I have a better idea. I’ll look for somewhere else to live and we can put the house up for sale.”

Her expression changed from flirtatious to shocked. “You don’t mean that.”

“Yes I fucking do.” I looked around the room. “We bought this place for a good price, and either one of us could probably afford to keep it. I don’t

want it. We can get it valued, and then you can decide if you want to buy me out. The alternative is to sell it and split the proceeds.”

“Rob, you can’t really—”

“I can, and I will.” I shrugged, suddenly too weary to continue the conversation. “I’ll sleep in the spare room until I can find myself somewhere to stay.” I turned around and left the house. I got into my car and drove, not really thinking about where I was going.

For some reason, I’d taken the road out towards Bedford, where I’d met and fucked Elena. This time I stopped at the town of St Neots, which I’d driven past before. It was a picturesque town built around another river, though I wasn’t sure which one. I parked my car and walked for a long time through the small streets, then through a park that ran alongside the river. I bought myself an ice cream and sat on a bench to eat it, going through my conversation with Suzy.

I hadn’t expected her to be in the house so early, but the more I thought about it, it made sense because Terry probably needed to get back to Scotland and out to the oilrig. I knew I’d have to break the news of my failed marriage to my family, but I didn’t see them very often. My best friend already knew, and the guys at work hardly knew Suzy anyway.

My phone buzzed in my pocket. I took it out and was shocked to see five messages from Suzy. I opened them in order. The first was asking me to come home so we could talk about it. The second reminded me that it had been what we both wanted. The third and fourth were asking why I hadn’t replied, and the final message told me I was a childish twat.

I only replied to the first:

For some reason, all five messages have just arrived together. I'll be home later, but I think everything's been said. I know it was a joint decision to start swinging, but it's obvious that you have no intention of stopping. It is what it is. I'd like to think we can get through the next stage without resorting to name-calling, but maybe that's asking too much.

After I'd sent the text, I opened my email. As I'd expected, there was nothing from Cyndi, but I sent her one with a couple of lines telling her I hoped things were going okay and that I was thinking of her. Then I walked back to my car and drove towards Cambridge.

When I got home, Suzy was halfway between the shed and the house wearing her cycling kit.

"Are you going out?" I asked.

"I've been out." She walked past me and in through the backdoor without looking me in the face.

I followed her in, and she went upstairs. I dropped into the armchair and closed my eyes. I heard the bathroom door close and then the shower running. Twenty minutes later she returned wearing a pair of leggings and a jumper.

"I'm meeting a friend from work for dinner," she said.

I nodded, and she gave a sarcastic smile. "It's a woman, and I know she has a spare room because her lodger has just moved out."

I didn't get time to reply before she turned around and left. Then she came back in. "Will you move your car so I can get mine out?"

I went out and reversed onto the road. Suzy drove out of the drive and away down the road without looking my way, so I put my car back in the

drive and walked into the house. Suzy hadn't returned by the time I went to bed. I checked my phone but there were no texts from her.

She didn't come home that night, and I went to work as usual. When I got back on Monday evening, there was a note on the coffee table.

Rob – You're probably right that things are no longer the same between us, and I now accept that we'll never be able to go back to what we had before. It happened in Mexico, but it wasn't me who changed. I did all the things that used to turn us both on, and that's exactly all I've been doing since we returned home. So while I know things are no longer the same, I think you need to take a look at yourself before you lay the blame at my door. I'm not the one who's changed.

I'll be taking the next couple of days off work to move my stuff to my new lodgings. If you want to get the ball rolling with the estate agent, we can sell the house and go our separate ways.

I'm sorry it's turned out this way. Maybe we should have talked to each other more between the sex. Suzy x

I read the letter twice. During the first reading, anger and sadness coursed through my mind. As I read it a second time, I wondered if it *had* been me who'd changed in Mexico. Then I remembered the state Suzy had been in after her night out with Daisy. She'd been too drunk to talk but had still managed to pull a train on the terrace. She hadn't done that to turn me on, she'd done it to hurt me. She'd been mad at me for not acting like the perfect little cuck that Jarad was for Daisy.

I realised the strongest emotion I now felt was relief. I sank into the armchair, dropped my head back and closed my eyes. It was over, and for

the first time since Mexico, it felt like a burden had been lifted off my shoulders.

* * * *

On Tuesday I phoned an estate agent and arranged for them to come value the house. That evening, I discovered Suzy's wardrobe was empty and her bikes had been taken from the shed. By Wednesday evening, her exercise bike had disappeared from the spare bedroom, along with a lot of her knick-knacks and ornaments.

I made myself a stir-fry and ate it at the kitchen table. I clicked on the email app, and my heart soared. There was a short message from Cyndi.

I'm back in Alabama and can do a videocall whenever suits you.

Cyndi xxxxxxxx

I glanced at my watch and knew it'd be a little after one in the afternoon in Alabama. She'd probably be teaching at school, but I replied to say I could do a call any time she was free.

It took less than a minute for a response.

How about now?

I sent a thumbs-up emoji, abandoned my half-eaten dinner and rushed through to the living room. By the time I'd fired-up my laptop, there was a dialogue box inviting me to join the call.

I hit 'accept' and suddenly Cyndi's face filled my screen.

"Hey you," she said, flashing me a beautiful smile.

"Hi." Just hearing her voice gave me tingles. "How was the funeral?"

“It was an eye-opener. Turns out my dad had a lot of friends.” She shook her head as if she found that notion hard to believe. “They all said nice things about him, but then most of them didn’t know he’d deserted his first wife and child.”

“And your half-brother?”

She gave a sad shrug. “It’s hit him hard. He’s lost his father, and the move to Georgia means he’s going to lose all his friends, too. He’ll also need to settle into a new school, which is already causing him all kinds of stress.” She sighed, then shook her head and gave another smile. “So, how are things over in England?”

“Suzy and I split up.”

Her eyes went wide. “Wow. I’m sorry.”

“Are you?”

She frowned, then shook her head. “No, but I’m sorry that you’re going through something that can’t be pleasant. What happened?”

“It just got...” I shrugged, not wanting to go into the details of Suzy seeing another guy in front of all of my ex-army colleagues. “It’s been coming for a while, and I think we’ve both finally accepted the inevitable.”

“How are you?”

“Sad and angry, but mostly relieved.” I sighed. “It feels like a weight’s been lifted, and I almost hate myself for it.”

She nodded, her eyes now glistening with what looked like tears.

“Why aren’t you at school?” I asked.

“I just got back this morning, and the head told me to take some time to

grieve.”

“How much time?” My heart rate kicked up a notch.

She shrugged. “There’s no set period but, to be honest, I think it’d be better to keep myself busy.”

“Come over to England. We can grieve together.”

She blinked, then laughed. “I’d love to. We could grieve with me on top, and then with you on top.”

“I’m serious.”

“I can’t afford to—”

“I’ll buy your ticket.”

She frowned and shook her head. “Rob, I couldn’t let you do—”

“I love you.”

She stopped talking and stared at me. I immediately regretted saying it, but in my heart I knew it was true.

“I’m sorry,” I said, feeling stupid. “I shouldn’t have said that, but I...” I ran a hand through my hair, feeling desperate. “I haven’t stopped thinking about you since Mexico. I haven’t stopped missing you since then, either.”

A tear ran down her cheek. “I think about you all the time, too.”

“Even when you masturbate?”

She laughed out loud, then wiped her face and nodded. “Especially when I masturbate.”

“Get your phone out and book a flight.”

She shook her head. “I can’t allow you to...” She took a deep breath and let it out noisily through her nose. “I’ll save up and pretty soon I’ll be—”

“I can’t wait that long. Take out your phone and I’ll give you my card details for the payment.”

She shook her head again.

“Cyndi, please.”

She frowned but got up and walked out of shot, then returned with her phone. She sat down and tapped the screen several times. “Okay, there are no direct flights from Mobile or Birmingham to London.”

My pulse raged in my ears. “Where would you need to fly from?”

“Atlanta, probably.” She tapped her phone again. “There are several flights from Atlanta to London, Heathrow every day.”

“How far are you from Atlanta?”

“About a hundred and fifty miles.”

“Get a connecting flight to there, too.”

She laughed and shook her head. “I can take the train to Atlanta.”

“Buy a plane ticket now.”

She frowned at the screen. “You might want to think about—”

“No I don’t. Buy one.”

She clicked through the options then looked up. “It’s almost seven hundred dollars.”

“I don’t care.”

She chewed her lip. “That’s for the round trip. When do I want to come back?”

“Buy a one-way ticket. That way, there’ll be no set deadline, and we can buy a one-way ticket to take you back.”

“It’s more expensive that—”

“Stop worrying about the money.”

She laughed and checked her screen again. “When should I—?”

“As soon as possible.”

“There’s a flight out tonight.” She glanced up at something, possibly a clock on the wall facing her. “I could probably be there in time. It’ll be a couple of hours on the train, and it’s an eight-hour flight.” She let out a long breath. “I could be with you in about eighteen hours.”

“Do it. Book the flight, I’ll go get my bank card.”

I rushed over to pick up my wallet from the sideboard and dropped back into the armchair feeling happier than I’d felt in weeks. In ten minutes she had the ticket.

“What clothes should I pack?”

“You won’t need any.”

She laughed. “Dream on. I know men, and I know they soon run out of steam.”

I’d only seen Cyndi in the clothes she wore in the tropics. “Bring casual clothes, including something warm. Jeans, jumpers, t-shirts. Whatever you usually wear when it’s not as hot as it is in Mexico.”

She nodded, then looked nervous. “I can’t believe we’re doing this.”

I couldn’t either. “What time do you land at Heathrow?”

She checked her phone again. “Fifteen hundred hours, your time.”

I nodded. “I’ll be there.”

“God, I can’t...” She took a breath, then shook her head. “I need to book a cab and a train ticket. I need to pack, take a shower and...” She held her arm out in front of her, holding her hand straight out, fingers together. “I’m shaking.”

“Me too.”

“I need to start getting—”

“I know. I’ll see you tomorrow.”

She blinked, gave the most beautiful smile, then leaned forward and tapped the keyboard. The screen went black. I sat back in my chair and let out a long, stuttering breath. My face hurt from smiling.

I headed upstairs and cleaned the bathroom, vacuumed all three bedrooms and then returned downstairs to wash the plates and wok from my dinner. Next I cleaned the kitchen and living room. I’d call at the estate agents in the morning and drop off a key so they could do the valuation without me being there.

Before getting into bed I packed a suitcase. I had a plan for how I wanted to spend the next few days...

* * * *

I got up early, showered, shaved, and made sure the house looked okay. Then I left for work. Once there, I went to see my boss. I explained that Suzy and I had decided to separate and asked if I could take a few days off to get things sorted out. He was understanding and told me to take as much time as I needed. I offered to take unpaid leave, but he assured me that marital issues qualified for compassionate leave. I thanked him, told the

guys from the office I'd be taking some time off without mentioning why, and left at lunchtime.

I called at the estate agents to give them the house key, then drove to Heathrow. Once there, I had over an hour before Cyndi's plane landed, so I grabbed a coffee and used my phone to book us a hotel in London for a couple of nights.

I made my way to arrivals much earlier than I needed to, and I watched as what felt like a million people trudged past. I kept checking my watch and tried to guess how long it'd take for her to collect her baggage. The wait was interminable. I was nervous and chewed the inside of my lower lip so much that I eventually tasted blood. My legs shook with a mixture of excitement and dread.

What if she missed her flight? What if it's not the same as it was in Mexico?

Then I saw her. She wore a pale blue button-down shirt, grey jeans and white sneakers without socks. Cyndi looked slight, almost fragile, but her face broke into a beautiful smile when she saw me. I approached and she dropped her suitcase, throwing her arms around my neck. We kissed with two hundred people milling around us. I held her tight and breathed in her perfume. Reluctantly, I loosened my grip and broke the kiss.

Cyndi pulled her head back and looked up into my eyes. "I love you too."

I smiled, then kissed her again. All my doubts had disappeared. Finally releasing her, I picked up her suitcase and led her towards the exit. It felt good when she slipped her arm around my waist. We chattered like old

friends all the way to the car. I put her case next to mine in the boot, and when we got into the car we kissed again.

“I’ve booked a hotel,” I whispered.

“Good. Take me there and fuck me.” She smiled. “Will it take long?”

“This is London. The journey will last longer than the sex.”

She laughed and nuzzled my ear. “We only have to do the journey once. But the sex we’re going to do several times.”

I sighed, my cock straining inside my jeans. I drove as quickly as I could, but it still took the best part of an hour to get there. Once checked in, we took the lift to the fifth floor and hurried along the corridor to our room. As soon as the door closed behind us we dropped our suitcases and started undressing each other. I bent to kiss her bare shoulder as her shirt slipped off. She sucked my nipple and raked her nails over my back, then started on my belt and jeans buttons. As soon as we were both naked, I picked her up and carried her to the bed. I laid her down on the bedspread and climbed on top. Then I held myself above her, hardly believing we were together again.

Cyndi stroked my face, then reached down and guided my cock to her entrance. There was no mention of condoms or test results. I pushed into the wet heat of her body and let out a grateful sigh. She groaned and moved with me, clenching around my shaft as I fucked her slowly.

“Oh god,” she breathed, kissing my neck and running her hands over my back and shoulders. “God, I’ve missed you.”

I kissed her eyes, her cheeks, her nose and her forehead. She looked up at me and frowned, then I felt the grip of her orgasm. I smiled and kept moving. She let out little sobs as she came, then she kissed me and began

moving faster. Smiling, she knew her movements were driving me closer to my own climax.

My breathing became shallow, and Cyndi looked up into my eyes. I pulled out, and she moaned in disappointment. I shot a thick rope of cum over her stomach and chest. She gasped and looked down. I didn't touch my cock, and it twitched again, sending another rope up between our bodies. A third eruption coated our stomachs, then another. Cyndi frowned, obviously shocked by the amount I'd produced.

I reached down and fed my cock back inside her. She purred and pulled me close, smearing the cum between our heaving bodies and we fucked with abandon. I felt her come again. This time she cried out and scratched my back. I fucked her harder still, surprised I was still hard. I felt the beginnings of another orgasm and chased it, sliding my cock in and out of her molten pussy as she wrapped her legs around mine and clung to my body. Cyndi came a third time as I fired my second load inside her. We both cried out, and she stared into my eyes as her body shuddered beneath me.

I let out a long, stuttering breath and collapsed on top of her.

"Hmm, well that was worth the journey." She looked at me and smiled. "Was it worth the four-hundred dollars you paid to get me here?"

"Just seeing you at the airport was worth the price of the ticket." I kissed her gently on the lips. "I'm sorry I made a mess."

She looked down and examined our glistening bodies. "Did you do that to prove you've been saving it up?"

I smiled and nodded. "Partly that, and partly because I knew if my first was outside, I'd probably be able to come a second time."

Her eyes widened. "You can come twice?"

"Sometimes, but not usually if the first is inside. That seems to take everything I have."

She smiled. "We'll try it out during my visit."

"Okay." I got up and went in search of tissues. I returned to the bed with a dampened hand towel proceeded to wipe the mess from her body, then Cyndi returned the favour.

"What do you want to do next?" she asked.

"How about we have a shower, you abuse my body again, then we'll go and get you something to eat."

"Okay."

I led her into the bathroom and turned on the shower. Pulling her close, I kissed her again. "I can't believe you're here."

"Me neither."

"I might not let you leave."

She looked up into my eyes, a serious expression on her beautiful face. "If you can fix it so I don't have to, I won't complain."

I kissed her again before we got into the shower. We washed each other's bodies under the hot spray. By the time we got out, she'd managed to get me fully hard again. We patted each other dry, then I lay on the bed and Cyndi straddled my knees. Keeping her big brown eyes fixed on mine, she lowered her head and took my cock into her mouth. I let out a sigh and watched as she slowly bobbed her head. Reluctantly, I eased her head up and pulled her further up my body. She impaled herself and rode me slowly. Lying there, watching her beautiful face and lithe body while experiencing

the sheer bliss of being inside her, I knew this was so much more than a casual fling. I felt truly happy.

Cyndi came first, and after she'd come I pulled her down and held her close while I thrust up into her. This time I didn't pull out, and as soon as she knew I was coming, she sat up and jerked her hips, grinding down until she got herself off again. We lay there for about half an hour, kissing and talking. I told her how Suzy had moved out, and that we were in the process of selling our house.

Then I told her my plan for the next few days.

"I thought we could spend tomorrow in London, so you can see the sights."

"I'd like that." She grinned. "Will we be able to sneak back here and have sex every hour?"

I laughed and nodded. "We'll stay here again tomorrow night, and then the next morning we'll drive up to Scotland."

"Okay."

"It's a long way."

"I don't care because I'll be with you."

I ran my hands over her back, then remembered how knackered I'd been when we returned from Mexico. "Have you slept at all? I'm sorry, I never thought about the jetlag and—"

"I slept on the plane, and I'm fine." She frowned. "But I am hungry."

We showered and dressed, then headed out and caught a tube to central London. We ate in a small Italian bistro, then wandered along the embankment and saw the Houses of Parliament and Big Ben. We had sex

again when we returned to the hotel, and for the first time weeks, I held another body close to mine while I slept. During the second day we saw as many sights as I could think of. We also returned to the hotel on three separate occasions to work off our lust.

The drive to Scotland took us most of the following day, but it was worth it just to see Cyndi's face while driving through Glencoe. We spent the night at a bed and breakfast in a small town on the west coast.

The following day, everything was perfect – the weather, the mountains, the sea, the small stone houses, even the Highland cattle wandering through one of the villages. Cyndi's face was a picture, and all the locals we met were enchanted by her. We drove all the way up to the very north of the country, seeing John O'Groats and the fabulous white-sand beaches that looked more like the French Riviera than Scotland. We stayed overnight in the picturesque village of Bonar Bridge. Cyndi found the name hilarious, and I made sure to give her my 'boner' the last thing that night and again first thing the following morning. I made sure we drove past Loch Ness on our journey south, and we spent the afternoon and night in Edinburgh. She loved the castle and the historic buildings. Cyndi said she was concerned about how much money it was costing me, but I really didn't care. I was having the time of my life.

We headed back south after our night in Edinburgh, and I had an idea. "Well," I said, smiling at Cyndi who was curled up in the passenger seat. "You've seen England, and you've seen Scotland, so how do you feel about visiting Wales?"

She gave me a smile and nodded. "Is it as far?"

I laughed and shook my head. “The bit we’re going to is actually only just over the border, but there’s someone I’d like you to meet.”

Her eyes went wide. “Who?”

“Two of my closest friends.” I smiled. “Don’t worry, I’ve already told them about you.”

It was after five when we stopped at a motorway services for a coffee. I called Stig to ask if they were going to be in later, and he said he was. “Cool,” I said, cryptically. “I’ll see you in a couple of hours.”

I pulled up outside Stig and Mandy’s Wrexham home and we got out of the car. They both came out and gave me a hug, then smiled broadly as I introduced them to Cyndi.

We all headed inside. Mandy looked at Cyndi and shook her head. “He never told me you were so gorgeous.”

Cyndi laughed and looked suitably embarrassed. “I’m surprised he told you about me at all.” She looked from Stig and Mandy to me. “So, how do you all know each other?”

“We all served in the army. Stig and I went through basic training together, and we met Mandy in Afghanistan. She was an army nurse.”

“Oh wow.” Cyndi smiled, then asked, “Are you still in the army?”

Mandy shook her head. “No, though I’m still a nurse.”

Stig offered us a drink, but I pointed out I was driving.

“Stay the night,” Mandy said. “I’ll make us something to eat, and we can all have a drink and a proper catch-up.”

We spent a lovely evening with my two closest friends, and at the end of the night Mandy gave Cyndi a hug. Cyndi went up first, and as I helped our

hosts carry the plates and glasses to the kitchen, Mandy stepped close.

“Why didn’t you tell us she was black?”

I shrugged. “It didn’t seem important.”

“It isn’t, and I can see why you’re smitten.” She was smiling.

I grinned. “You approve?”

She nodded. “What are you going to do?”

“You mean when I get into bed?”

She slapped my arm and scowled. “You know what I mean.”

“I don’t know.” I sighed. “I know it’s early days. I’m still married to Suzy and there’ll be a whole load of shit to wade through before I’m in any sort of position to make plans for the future, but I haven’t felt this way for...” I shrugged. “I don’t think I’ve *ever* felt this way. I don’t like the idea of being without her.”

Mandy smiled and put her hand on my arm. “I’ve seen the way you two look at each other. Make it work.”

“She has a life in the States, a mother, a job, kids she tutors for free because she cares about them. It might be easier for me to move over there, but the way the Trump administration treats non-nationals worries me. I’ve looked up the rules for her coming here, though. She can stay for at least six months without a visa.”

“You’ve already looked into it?” Stig sounded surprised, but then he clammed up as he looked at something over my shoulder. I turned and saw Cyndi there, her eyes wide.

I smiled sheepishly. “Hi.”

She smiled at me. “I was going to ask you to get my toothbrush from the car, but then I overheard...” She frowned.

“I was just explaining how I intend to kidnap you and never let you leave.”

Cyndi nodded slowly. “That works for me. Will you lock me in a room?”

I nodded.

“Will there be a bed in the room?”

“Oh yeah.”

She tilted her head to one side, a habit I now loved. “Will you tie me to the bed sometimes?”

Mandy laughed and walked over to give Cyndi another hug. “You’re going to make him very happy.”

Cyndi looked at me with her big, beautiful eyes. “I promise to try.”

I got the toiletries bag from the car, and we all headed up to our rooms. In bed, Cyndi made love to me slowly. We were quiet throughout, hardly moving at all. She came silently, and I came just after her. Then I held her in my arms until she fell asleep on my chest.

I lay in the dark and marvelled at how good I felt. It was just over a week since my marriage had ended, and I was already holding someone who I never wanted to let go. I knew there’d be decisions to make, but I was happy to do whatever it took for us to be together. I’d live on either side of the Atlantic so long as I was with Cyndi.

I dreaded to think what Suzy would say when she found out who I was with, but the truth was I didn’t care. Maybe she was right. Maybe Cyndi

was the reason I changed in Mexico. My marriage was over no matter what. An open relationship may have been exciting and fun for a while, but ultimately it hadn't worked out the way I expected. I hoped Cyndi felt the same way about her adventures in swinging, because the last thing I wanted to do was to share her with anybody else. But that was too far down the line to think about. Maybe we'd just have a few months together and she'd yearn for the excitement of sex with strangers again. Or maybe what we had would last and always feel special.

I kissed her face in the dark and heard her let out a contented sigh. I didn't feel the need to sleep with anyone but Cyndi, and all I could do was hope she didn't want anyone else.

THE END

[Delores Swallows](#)

United Kingdom (2025)

ABOUT THE AUTHOR



Delores Swallows has many dirty thoughts, and during his free time he writes them down in the form of stories. Born and bred in the northwest of England, he has a commoner's accent and a bit of a crush on his future queen.

His stories often feature petite brunettes, high-heeled shoes and voyeurism. He claims he didn't realise these were obsessions until someone pointed out how often they appear in his work.

Find out more about Delores on his [website](#). He loves to hear from his readers by [email](#). He also has a [Patreon](#) account where you can get early access to - and interact with him about - his latest books, plus other goodies as well.

And don't forget to sign up to his [mailing list](#) for a **free story**.

ALSO BY DELORES SWALLOWS



Their Justification



Danielle and Matt are now fully immersed in their new lifestyle, with Cara becoming a regular presence in their nights of fun. This helps Matt with the books he's writing – all he needs to do is transcribe the action from the bedroom in his manuscript.

When he's invited to a celebratory party for a computer magazine, Danielle isn't interested in accompanying him – until she learns the party is being held in Paris. While there, they take in more than just the sites thanks to a chance meeting with Marion and Romain. This encounter provides Matt with even more material for his book.

With Matt enjoying the charms of other women, Danielle becomes a little concerned that his final book of the trilogy is veering away from the hotwife genre and becoming more of a polyamory tale. In an attempt to help him regain his focus, she books herself the perfect bull for the evening and

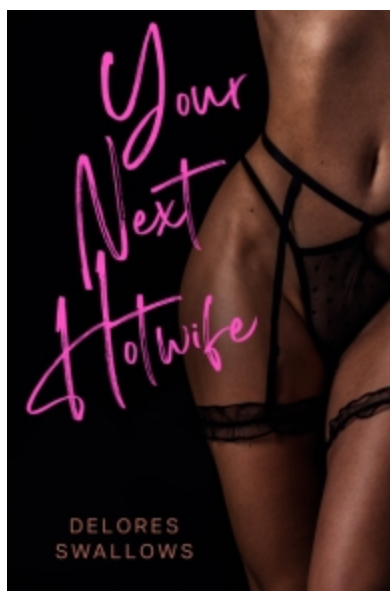
forces Matt to listen from the spare room. And for the book's finale, Danielle and Cara engage in a night of unrestrained passion with six hunky men from the rowing club.

What more could an author ask of his hotwife?

Their Justification is available [here](#)



Your Next Hotwife



Vivienne inadvertently discovers husband Lee's laptop still logged on after he leaves for a work trip. The scantily clad women on the webpage pique her curiosity. Thinking she might be able to give him a sexy treat if she knows what sort of porn he watches, she takes a closer look.

Then her world collapses.

It isn't a porn site - it's a contact forum. Lee's been moonlighting as a bull for couples who live the hotwife/cuckold lifestyle. Not only are there

sexy women offering him their bodies, he's also getting requests from husbands to satisfy their wives' carnal desires.

About to call Lee and tell him not to bother coming home ever again, Viv realises this confrontation needs to be done face to face. The inevitable denials and elaborate lies would hurt her even more. So she comes up with a good old honeytrap plan.

She registers as 'Brandy' and sends a request saying, 'Let me be your next hotwife'. When he turns up at the hotel, there'll be no way for him to try and sweet-talk his way out of his duplicity.

But there's something Vivienne hasn't considered: the forum has many bulls looking for sexy hotwives to service...

Your Next Hotwife is available [here](#).